

OUR VOICES: A GUIDE TO CITING PERSONAL EXPERIENCE AND INTERVIEWS IN RESEARCH



*Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and
Jake Lally*
University of Washington

Our Voices: A Guide to Citing Personal Experience and Interviews in Research

This text is disseminated via the Open Education Resource (OER) LibreTexts Project (<https://LibreTexts.org>) and like the thousands of other texts available within this powerful platform, it is freely available for reading, printing, and "consuming."

The LibreTexts mission is to bring together students, faculty, and scholars in a collaborative effort to provide an accessible, and comprehensive platform that empowers our community to develop, curate, adapt, and adopt openly licensed resources and technologies; through these efforts we can reduce the financial burden born from traditional educational resource costs, ensuring education is more accessible for students and communities worldwide.

Most, but not all, pages in the library have licenses that may allow individuals to make changes, save, and print this book. Carefully consult the applicable license(s) before pursuing such effects. Instructors can adopt existing LibreTexts texts or Remix them to quickly build course-specific resources to meet the needs of their students. Unlike traditional textbooks, LibreTexts' web based origins allow powerful integration of advanced features and new technologies to support learning.



LibreTexts is the adaptable, user-friendly non-profit open education resource platform that educators trust for creating, customizing, and sharing accessible, interactive textbooks, adaptive homework, and ancillary materials. We collaborate with individuals and organizations to champion open education initiatives, support institutional publishing programs, drive curriculum development projects, and more.

The LibreTexts libraries are Powered by [NICE CXone Expert](#) and was supported by the Department of Education Open Textbook Pilot Project, the California Education Learning Lab, the UC Davis Office of the Provost, the UC Davis Library, the California State University Affordable Learning Solutions Program, and Merlot. This material is based upon work supported by the National Science Foundation under Grant No. 1246120, 1525057, and 1413739.

Any opinions, findings, and conclusions or recommendations expressed in this material are those of the author(s) and do not necessarily reflect the views of the National Science Foundation nor the US Department of Education.

Have questions or comments? For information about adoptions or adaptations contact info@LibreTexts.org or visit our main website at <https://LibreTexts.org>.

The LibreTexts name, logo, and book covers are trademarked by LibreTexts, Inc. (a 501(c)(3) not-for-profit organization) and protected against unauthorized use.

This text was compiled on 08/14/2026

- [InfoPage](#) by [Delmar Larsen](#) is licensed [Public Domain](#).

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Licensing

1: The Guidelines

- 1.1: Introduction
- 1.2: Framing
- 1.3: Collaborative Design
- 1.4: Bringing Theory into Practice
- 1.5: Discussion and Reflections
- 1.6: Conclusion
- 1.7: The Guidelines
- 1.8: Bibliography

2: Classroom Tools

- 2.1: Sample Syllabus
- 2.2: Consent Form
- 2.3: Course Design
- 2.4: Interview Best Practices

3: Open Data

- 3.1: Course Evaluation Notes
- 3.2: Notes from Interviews with Students (2018)
- 3.3: Notes from Interviews with Students (2019)
- 3.4: Notes from Interview with Graduate Student (2020)
- 3.5: Notes from Interviews with Professors and Instructors
- 3.6: 2019 Praxis Presentation

Index

Glossary

Detailed Licensing

Detailed Licensing

Licensing LicensingEdit Update titlecancel

A detailed breakdown of this resource's licensing can be found in [Back Matter/Detailed Licensing](#).

CHAPTER OVERVIEW

1: The Guidelines

- 1.1: Introduction
- 1.2: Framing
- 1.3: Collaborative Design
- 1.4: Bringing Theory into Practice
- 1.5: Discussion and Reflections
- 1.6: Conclusion
- 1.7: The Guidelines
- 1.8: Bibliography

This page titled [1: The Guidelines](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard](#), [Emma Macdonald-Scott](#), and [Jake Lally](#).

1.1: Introduction 1.1: IntroductionEdit Update titlecancel

1

Introduction

Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally

How do we know what we know, and how is that knowledge valued? Why is some knowledge deemed more valuable or valid than others? What if a person has multiple degrees, or even a university education? Is their knowledge more valuable? What if a person has not been formally trained on research methodologies? Do the person's personal lived experiences still have value in their own academic research?

These were questions that arose in class discussions among undergraduates and a graduate student instructor in the context of learning about international justice mechanisms and the admissibility of evidence in international court proceedings, where we discussed hierarchies of truth and knowledge. We were wrestling with questions about the possibility of an objective truth, reliability of eyewitness and survivor testimony, and what justice means and to whom.

Out of these discussions, we realized how limited conventional citation guidelines were in recognizing and validating the full range of knowledge and experience students wanted and needed to bring to their research papers for the class. While academia has a strong tradition of in-depth interviews with "research subjects" in ethnographic research and autoethnography as an autobiographical form of writing and research, we wanted to acknowledge and address the power imbalance in these accepted forms of research. Ethnographic (or qualitative), interpretivist research is often seen as less objective or "valid" in disciplinary debates, whereas quantitative, positivist work is often seen as more objective and "pure."^[1] This hierarchy of knowledge production reinforces colonial practices, and western, white epistemologies.

We wanted to raise up the value and validity of **personal interviews** which we define as more informal conversations with friends, family, and neighbors, for example: the story that has been told around your dinner table for generations, or stories neighbors and family friends have shared for as long as you can remember. This type of "interview" is really more of a conversation and can be rich with context and cultural meaning, and deeply personal. These interviews are closely aligned with lived experience. The "interviewer" is in a unique position to be able to speak to this rich context in ways that more traditional ethnographic interviews by outsiders are not able to.

Similarly, we wanted to uplift and validate **personal experiences** beyond the traditional uses in autoethnographic research. This was motivated by Emily's experience as a teaching assistant. She was grading a student's paper about Latin America and the student failed to provide a citation for a historical event that was described in the paper. According to the grading rubric and conventional expectations, the student was supposed to lose points on the assignment. However, after speaking with the student, Emily learned that the student had lived through the event themselves. The expectation was that the student find a secondary or other primary source to cite, other than their own lived experience or those of their community. There was no convention for them to cite their own personal knowledge even though they lived through it. External sources were valued higher than the student's own lived, embodied knowledge.

In order to address these concerns, we the authors created a set of guidelines for students to cite their own personal experience and personal interviews in academic research papers that allows for the inclusions of more diverse forms of knowledge production. While there are still arguably some concerns with the convention of citations in general, we wanted to give students and educators practical tools to adapting existing academic practices and expectations to include these traditionally less-valued forms of knowledge production and acknowledge the value of the lived experiences of students and their communities. We wanted to give students the opportunity to center their own knowledge and experience, as well as that of their community.

The first set of guidelines were used in 2018, created in direct response to student's needs to cite personal experience and family interviews in their research papers. After the course, Emily, the instructor, interviewed several of the students who used the citation guidelines for feedback and recruited 2 students (Emma and Jake) who had an interest in continuing to develop the guidelines, forming the team that continued to work for the next 4 years to create additional iterations of the guidelines, conduct interviews with students and professors, and search for additional research on development of citation guidelines. Through encouragement of several professors and research librarians, we decided to create this e-book to share the guidelines open source, providing an important tool for students, as well as a starting point for others to continue building, improving, and drawing from our work

through a Creative Commons license. More traditional publishing platforms proved to be too limited, closed, and inflexible to meet our needs.

Our hope is that this guide to citing personal experience and interviews meets our goal of supporting students to produce their own knowledge, as well as honoring the academic value of their lived experience and the experiences of their families and communities. Through the use of a set of guidelines we created for students to cite personal experience and interviews, we found students self-reported increase in engagement and success in academic assignments. We propose this set of guidelines as an important practical tool for critical, feminist, and anti-racist pedagogy, as well as a method for teaching ethical research.

Scholars across disciplines are moving toward challenging the status quo in classrooms, and in research. In recent years, the movement to engage in anti-racist pedagogy has strengthened as the United States wrestles with legacies of colonization and racism which continue to permeate our ways of life in this country. Kyoko Kishimoto writes of the need for the practical application of critical race theory, not simply about what is taught in the classroom, but *how* it is taught. Kishimoto argues that anti-racist, feminist, and critical pedagogy “critique positivist assumptions of knowledge, of an objective universal truth which fails to acknowledge embedded Eurocentrism and male privilege.”^[2]

Alongside the movement for anti-racist pedagogy, Indigenous ways of knowing have always challenged these ideas. It is inherent in Indigenous cultural practices like oral and embodied histories. The Indigenous Studies discipline challenges the traditional, rigid separation of “the researcher” and “research subjects.” Instead of the strict boundaries in research, scholars call for collaborative research that values diverse forms of knowledge production, and partnership. Kimberly TallBear writes about this approach as “standing with.” As TallBear argues, “standing with” seeks to build relationship based out of mutual care and concern.^[3]

Broader discussion of citations guidelines for scholars has been actively developing. There are more tools now in 2022 than when we originally started this project back in 2018. Most disciplines encourage and value boundaries and distance between the researcher and the researched.^[4] Further, researchers are discouraged from studying issues related to their own community.^[5] However, there is a movement within Indigenous Studies and critical theory that values diverse forms of knowledge production.^[6] There is a movement in various disciplines to value connections between researchers and communities, and collaborative projects.^[7] There is an extensive body of literature that argues for a breakdown of this barrier as a way to decolonize research.^[8] Some scholars write about the politics of citation, encouraging more inclusive and diverse conversations in the academe.^[9] Scholars in education studies and critical pedagogy write about rethinking-knowledge production and citations as a way to address equity and racism.^[10]

These guidelines explain and provide examples of how to cite personal experience, the proper structure of the citation, adapted from Chicago, APA, and MLA citation formats, and additional reading suggestions. This guide also provides information about how to cite personal interviews and conversations, including the importance of obtaining consent from the person you are interviewing. These guidelines are proposed in an effort to move toward decolonizing the classroom in a practical way by making space for diverse forms of knowledge production by people who have lived experiences in the contexts we study, but also to make space for the forms of knowledge production that students—along with their communities and families—create as valuable parts of their research.

Through a collaborative process of implementation and evaluation of the use of the guidelines, four outcomes emerged: students consider their own relationship to their research whether or not they use the guidelines; students think critically about all sources, not just those they cite; students bring their own passion and knowledge into the classroom; and students report increased engagement and success in class. As a result, we hope that the use of these guidelines, which foster student knowledge production and deep engagement with course material, can be an important way to decolonize the classroom, bring a diversity of voices into the classroom, and serve as an important tool for critical, feminist, and anti-racist pedagogy.

In the following sections, we will explain how we developed the guidelines and evaluated their impact on students’ academic research and assignments. We will also discuss our suggestions for using the guidelines based on student feedback, as well as areas for further research.

-
1. Willard, Emily, doctoral dissertation program, class discussions, conversations with professors and classmates. University of Washington, Seattle, WA, 2015-2020. ↵
 2. Kishimoto (2018), p. 541 ↵
 3. TallBear (2014) ↵
 4. Emerson, Fretz, and Shaw (1995); Gerring (2012) ↵

5. Willard, Emily, doctoral dissertation program, class discussions, conversations with professors and classmates. University of Washington, Seattle, WA, 2015-2020 [↩](#)
6. Kovach (2009); Tuhiwai-Smith (2012); Stoler (2006); Thomas (2015); Strega and Brown (2015) [↩](#)
7. Bishop (1998); Moses et al (1984); Baumann (2019). [↩](#)
8. Audra Simpson (2007), Stuart Hall (1996) [↩](#)
9. Mott and Cockyane (2017); Tuck, Yang, and Gaztambide-Fernández (2015) [↩](#)
10. Kindon and Ellwood (2009); Kishimoto (2018); Trott, McMeeking, and Weinberg (2019); Cammarota and Romero (2009) [↩](#)

This page titled [1.1: Introduction](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard](#), [Emma Macdonald-Scott](#), and [Jake Lally](#).

1.2: Framing 1.2: FramingEdit Update titlecancel

2

Framing

Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally

Incorporating personal experience into academic research is taboo. These concerns have been framed in terms of credibility and objectivity but there are also significant power structures underlying this practice. We do not dispute the importance of credibility and objectivity in academic research which are necessary elements of reliable knowledge production. Rather, we argue that there is room for the inclusion of personal experience citation in existing practices. It would not necessarily constitute the central evidence of an argument but would rather be incorporated to add context and in-depth knowledge which adds value to the research. As student bodies diversify, they bring new perspectives and new areas of focus for research but are confined to using sources that reflect the older white perspective, or the sources may not exist at all. The model developed in this project invites students to critically examine knowledge production practices and appropriately incorporate personal experience into their work.

We respect the need for credible knowledge production and the role of academia as a source of truth. We have developed our guidelines to decolonize knowledge production without degrading the quality of academic work. Our argument is not that knowledge should be constructed primarily on personal experience which would open the door to fabrication and erosion of truth. Rather, personal experience should be used to challenge or support new or existing explanations or knowledge. It can also reintroduce valuable context to data that may have been lost in the pursuit of objectivity. It is time to recognize the value that direct personal experience can bring to academic understanding. While our focus for this project is on undergraduate students, we believe our argument extends to mainstream academia as well.

It is important to first examine why academia holds the power that it does. Academia originated as an exclusive institution whose membership was restricted to white men of means. By extension, it excluded the perspectives and knowledge of anyone who did not fit that status. As its power grew, academia monopolized knowledge production by establishing itself as the only credible source of information. This meant that any work examining the world was done exclusively from a privileged perspective. The practice continues to this day, primarily in the form of requiring an institutional degree that acts as a “license” to produce knowledge. Because of the high resource barrier to entry, this license continues to be extended to people of privileged identities.

This results in the exclusion of an entire class of people from contributing to knowledge production and the exclusion of underprivileged voices. A striking example of this occurred when a coauthor of this paper was asked to give written testimony in support of an asylum application. We found this odd because there was no way for an academic thousands of miles away to verify a firsthand report, only make an informed guess that the asylum seeker was telling the truth. This example illustrates the paradox we identified where a person’s lived experience is less credible than another individual’s expertise, even though that expertise may not come from anything concrete. This is frequently the case in academia where knowledge often comes from the classroom and readings. By requiring that students only use sources that have been generated under this structure, it excludes new areas of research that are equally as valuable. Hence, we seek to challenge this hierarchy of knowledge production by expanding the sources of knowledge primarily by privileging students to include marginalized identities by sharing their lived experiences.

A problem central to the issue of citing personal experience is the requirement of a mediator which typically takes the form of an interviewer. Incorporating personal experience into a research project or study is a core element of conducting academic work. Yet, for this information to be considered credible, it must pass through a mediator. It is an effort to preserve credibility but is nonsensical. An experience does not change whether it is cited directly from an author or passes through an interviewer first. In fact, requiring the experience to pass through a mediator first may distort the message as it is then subject to the mediator’s biases and positionality that may not provide as rich an outcome. Passing information through a mediator is an accepted practice that aims to preserve credibility by ensuring an author does not make up false information and claim it as truth. However, the presence of a mediator does not guarantee accurate or truthful responses. If one is to argue that it does improve the truthfulness of the information, that turns the mediator into an arbiter of truth, an impossible task as well as one that reinforces the academic’s position of power. Who is a mediator to say that an experience is legitimate or not? Requiring a mediator acts as a barrier to the entry of diverse perspectives into academia. Direct use of personal experience challenges this power structure by directly empowering an author.

We address the potential complication that appears to arise from this system of author-based knowledge production: its abuse by authors seeking to spread misinformation. To illustrate the difference between legitimate and illegitimate use of personal knowledge, the example of a Holocaust denier is potent. Claiming that the Holocaust did not happen is an illegitimate use of personal experience citation because 1) it forms the basis for a piece of knowledge instead of supporting it, 2) it is not possible to live a negative experience, and 3) it is not an experience but a claim. However, the personal experience of an author who has interacted with Holocaust deniers and wishes to leverage their personal experience alongside other sources would constitute a valid use of the guidelines. Our framework does not invite opinion, it only considers real lived experience.

Our goal is to bring a working understanding of knowledge production to the classroom and explore the ways it can be incorporated into student work. It will challenge problematic citation practices and gives life to new voices and perspectives. Students will be encouraged to think about their own role in research and future knowledge production which benefits all research, even quantitative work. We also found that student engagement increased when they could bring their own experiences into the work they did. Finally, it is an important tool for critical, feminist, and anti-racist pedagogy because of the challenge to existing power structures that it poses.

This page titled [1.2: Framing](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard](#), [Emma Macdonald-Scott](#), and [Jake Lally](#).

1.3: Collaborative Design 1.3: Collaborative DesignEdit Update titlecancel

3

Collaborative Design

Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally

These guidelines were developed out of a need to allow students to use their own life experience, and the lived experience of their families and communities in their course assignments and research. When assignments require evidence to support arguments, students need a way to cite their own experiences as evidence. We needed a structure to guide students to think about their research critically, and also ensure accountability.

The development of these citation guidelines was developed in class discussions for the course International Justice on Trial in Autumn 2018 in the University of Washington's Law, Society, and Justice (LSJ) Department. Emily was instructor for the course, Emma and Jake were students in the course. Development of the need of the citations arose out of discussions about fourth person testimony, a form of Indigenous testimony and knowledge production as presented in Gerald Vizenor's *Native Liberty*.^[1] Discussions diverse forms of knowledge production^[2] and the existence of multiple truths^[3] highlighted the need for the guidelines. In addition, Emily's own research into knowledge production and the colonization of knowledge helped develop the guidelines and highlighted the need for them.^[4]

Emily presented the first draft of the guidelines to the course, International Justice on Trial in Autumn 2018. The main course assignment was for students to research a conflict and evaluate justice efforts and propose alternative approaches to justice. Student chose their own research topic and were encouraged to pick a topic that interested them. Six students used the citation guide, and Emily interviewed 10 students, five who used the guidelines, and five who did not. Out of these students who participated in interviews, three students expressed interested in participating in the further development of these guidelines and two of which are the co-authors of this article: Emma and Jake.

We used the feedback from the interviews and edited the guidelines to include examples of how to incorporate the citations into the text of the assignment. The citations were used in another course, Human Rights in Latin America for the Jackson School of International Studies department in the summer of 2019, and again for the International Justice on Trial course in autumn 2019. For each course, we solicited feedback from students through the anonymous course evaluation survey, resulting in a total of 60 responses out of 69 students in the three courses. With student permission, we analyzed samples of how the students incorporate the citations into their research papers.

In addition to soliciting feedback from students who used the guidelines, we also spoke with university faculty, and student workers at the university writing center. We conducted the interviews and developed the survey. In an effort to consider the use of the guidelines for a broader audience, a group of graduate students in the University of Washington School of Social Work used the guidelines to cite personal experience in a group project. We conducted interviews with a total of 13 undergraduate students and 1 graduate student who used the guidelines. Unfortunately, Emily was not able to conduct interviews with the 2019 group of students who had access to the guidelines in the "International Justice on Trial" course that year.

In response to this feedback, we continued to edit the guidelines to provide additional instruction about how to use them, we created an interview consent form as an instructional tool, as well as a form of accountability. Throughout this process we wanted to ensure ethical research practices, and also find a way to support students to produce their best work and see their own value as knowledge producers. We hope that these guidelines can continue to be updated and improved through a collaborative process with other instructors, students, and in other fields, departments, and institutions.

1. Vizenor, 2009. ↩
2. Kirsten Anker, 2005 ↩
3. Mark Rifkin, 2017 ↩
4. Tuck 2009, Thomas 2015, Tuhwai-Smith, 2012, Baumann 2019. ↩

This page titled [1.3: Collaborative Design](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally](#).

1.4: Bringing Theory into Practice 1.4: Bringing Theory into PracticeEdit Update titlecancel

4

Bringing Theory into Practice

Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally

In the course, International Justice on Trial, developed by Emily, students explored international justice systems and evaluated the effectiveness of different approaches to achieving justice through class discussion, assigned readings, individual research, and writing assignments.^[1] Students considered alternative approaches to justice using case studies from Guatemala, El Salvador, Rwanda, and Bosnia. The overarching question for was “What is Justice?” For the research assignment, students were asked to choose an issue area, region, or country with context of human rights violations. They were also asked to provide a definition of what they think justice is. Then, they were asked to evaluate the effectiveness of judicial trials to achieve justice, by identifying those trials that worked and did not work according to their own definition of justice. Finally, they were asked to propose alternative approaches to justice that would address shortcomings of existing efforts. Students were required to submit a research topic proposal early in the course, then submit a rough draft mid-way through the course, and a final paper at the end. The instructor provided extensive written feedback at the draft stage.

For the first course in autumn 2018, the guidelines were developed during the second half of the class, a product of class discussions and presented to the class.^[2] A total of five students out of 23 used the guidelines in their papers. Two students used the guidelines to cite personal or family experience, three students cited personal interviews. Through interviews and anonymous course evaluations,^[3] we found that even students who didn’t cite personal interviews or personal experience in their papers, still found that the guidelines made them think about their relationship to their research and encouraged them to think critically about all of their sources. Through interviews, students explained why they used the citation guidelines, and any challenges they had. In response to student feedback, we edited the guidelines to make the examples of how to use them and not use them clearer, and to add the information about informed consent. Subsequent edits created examples for how students can incorporate the quotations and citations into their papers, and an informed consent form to increase transparency among students, the instructor, and the interviewee.

We found through the interviews with students, and reviewing student use of the citations, that these guidelines can be an important tool for anti-racist pedagogy. Kyoko Kishimoto writes that the following are goals of anti-racist pedagogy: promotes critical analysis skills and awareness of social position; decenters authority in the classroom, and encourages students to take responsibility for their own learning; empowers students and applies theory to practice; and creates a sense of community.^[4] We argue that the citation guidelines that we developed meet the majority, if not all, of these goals, and can easily be used along methods of anti-racist pedagogy.

As an example,^[5] one student used the guidelines to cite personal family experience as Mexican Americans, and her own experiences on a research trip to the U.S.-Mexico Border for her research paper assignment. In her research on U.S. immigration detention centers, she found that she needed evidence to counter sources and information on the Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) website. In order to make a convincing argument, she wanted first-hand information about the effects of immigration detention. She explained:

“People don’t have personal experience in the articles we read. I can reference how I see it through my eyes, and how I interpret it. I can use it to make the case in my paper. The stuff I cite through family experience is not what you would find in academic papers... It’s important to represent how I experience the world because of my background.”^[6]

The student was able to analyze the existing sources and based on her own life experience and the experiences of her family, she was able to identify the lack of representation of a key viewpoint in her research. From her own sources of knowledge, she was able to provide the alternative viewpoint that was missing from the sources she was found in her research and incorporate it as evidence in her own paper. She was able to find the value in her own voice in her paper, and the presentation she gave to her classmates.

In another example,^[7] a student used the citation guidelines to interview a family friend from Turkey about the Kurdish Genocide in Turkish Kurdistan. In her outside research process, the student noted that she was having trouble finding much in the way of non-Western literature on the genocide, and none of the Turkish and other Middle Eastern authors who had written about it had

explicitly identified as Kurdish themselves. When she was able to connect with her Kurdish interviewee, she asked him about this disconnect and he believed it was attributed to the fact that the Turkish government is so intent on squashing Kurdish voices that much of the truth is confined to word of mouth. Further, he indicated that the systemic oppression of Kurdish Turks has led to less educational opportunities and thus less exposure to the academic media. Because of this, the student made more fruitful and nuanced discoveries about the situation from her interview with her subject who experienced the genocide firsthand than any of the secondary-experience literature she read. Oftentimes, the student noted, higher academia likes to take credit for deconstructing colonial barriers in education despite historically being a major institution upholding it. By privileging indigenous and minority truths, we can not only work to erase inequalities in academia but harness a powerful body of knowledge that is essential to mitigating and preventing atrocities like the Kurdish Genocide.

Even if students do not use the guidelines in their research projects, the goals of anti-racist pedagogy outlined by Kishimoto were still met. In cases where students did not use the guidelines, they reported that they nevertheless critically analyzed their sources and their own relationship to their research. One student reflected on her own experience as a white exchange student studying in South Africa. She said that when deciding whether or not she would cite her own personal experience studying the criminal justice system there, she decided that she would not due to her limited close relationships, and inability, due to time and access, to fully understand the situation. Upon reflection, she felt that she could have made more conscious observations as an outsider and would have felt more comfortable writing about her own experience as an outsider, but still hesitant about centering her experience as a white person.

-
1. Syllabus of “International Justice on Trial” course is provided in the supplemental materials. ↩
 2. In future iterations, the guidelines were presented along with the research paper assignment at the beginning of the course. ↩
 3. 21 out of 23 students participated in the anonymous course evaluation. ↩
 4. Kishimoto, p. 546. ↩
 5. We obtained informed consent from each student to use examples from their research papers, and to share quotations from their interviews. Student names are not used in order to protect personal privacy. ↩
 6. Interview with Student #1, conducted via telephone by Emily in January 2019. ↩
 7. Interview with Student #4, from autumn 2018 course. Interview via telephone in January 2019 by Emily. ↩
-

This page titled [1.4: Bringing Theory into Practice](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally](#).

1.5: Discussion and Reflections 1.5: Discussion and ReflectionsEdit Update titlecancel

5

Discussion and Reflections

Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally

Many scholars have acknowledged the structural limitations that created an academic sphere lacking in minority voices, yet few have presented ways to combat that lack of representation. Our guidelines actively work to integrate more diverse voices into academic research, and revere varied experiences and knowledge forms as essential parts of fully understanding any subject. Knowledge is richer when it is more inclusive and accessible. Particularly in education, the very business of knowledge production, academics should be concerned with giving students as many tools as possible to bring in more diverse voices, and to connect students more deeply with their subject matter. Our team created a set of guidelines to allow students to cite their personal experience, or interviews they conducted; as well as an accompanying set of teaching tools, to help instructors easily integrate discussions about knowledge production and valuation into their classes. We created this tool because we wanted to make integrating underrepresented perspectives easier, to create personal connections between students and their work, and because our research has shown that self-citation has a positive impact on students who use it.

In assessing and improving the self-citation guidelines, our team tried to stay true to the ideals of the guidelines themselves, drawing from a wide pool for feedback. We interviewed or surveyed undergraduate and graduate students, as well as instructors, librarians, and education scholars. The main goals in our assessment were to discern whether there was a demand for expanded citation methods, and whether students and instructors saw a benefit in introducing them. We also sought out concerns and suggestions for improvement as a way to integrate more voices into the actual formation of the guidelines, and to make them easier to use and understand.

Understanding the demand for expanded guidelines consists of understanding the limits of existing citation methods, and determining if there are students and instructors seeking what self-citation adds to those existing methods. There is currently no way to cite an informal interview or a student's own experience in a piece of writing.^[1] Existing methods cover published, or recorded oral histories, and formal interviews, but see personal experience and student conducted interviews as information to be, "referenced in text or a note"^[2], not worthy of citation. This creates an exclusivity around whose experiences are represented and valued in academia. The lack of representation in social science citation has been well documented in philosophy^[3], Communication^[4], Anthropology^[5], and legal studies^[6]. While social science is becoming a more diverse field, its diversity is often concentrated in students or early career professionals who are less frequently cited.^[7] Even when there are more diverse options to cite from, the politics of citation are such that older articles and authors who have been cited more, are seen as more credible and better sources to use. Even those within academia often see citations narrowly, as protections against plagiarism and as a reference to evidentiary support, but such a framework misses the power of citation.

Citation serves three main purposes: it proves the source of information so that interested parties may seek out further information, it shows credence and respect for the source of the information, and it works as a barrier to plagiarism. Self citation is an important practice beyond existing methods, because simply stating information an author created in the text, fails to provide the same respect and traceability that a citation provides. This is significant because the respect and traceability aspects of a citation have the greatest impact on how much visibility and value an author or piece of research can gain in their field of study. When we work within the existing framework, we are valuing knowledge by how well it adheres to rules and conventions, how it re-affirms and fits with existing research. When we expand that framework, we create new opportunities for out of the box thinking, to boost voices, and careers of those who deserve recognition regardless of their credentials, and we adopt rules and rhetoric which counteract racism and sexism within education.

Interviews and surveys with students and instructors fulfilled the practical side of understanding demand, in proving that there was a desire for self-citation among its target audience. A majority of instructors polled said they had encountered students interested in citing their own experience and more than three quarters had encountered students interested in citing interviews they had conducted themselves.^[8] In course evaluations from students who had been part of classes which taught using our guidelines, no student respondent thought that the guidelines were not helpful. 66% of students polled explicitly stated that the guidelines were a helpful tool, and all the remaining students noted that they had not used the guidelines and didn't feel the question applied to them.

Even still, of those who stated they did not use the guidelines, 60% specified that they nonetheless thought the guidelines were a good idea, even if they hadn't been able to use them. Instructors were, however, more hesitant about whether or not the guidelines would be helpful. Half of the instructors polled thought the guidelines would be helpful, and the rest primarily expressed a desire to review the guidelines more comprehensively before making a determination or voiced concerns which will be delved into in the latter part of this discussion. Beyond the aggregate, each instructor who participated in a longform interview and was able to thoroughly review and discuss the guidelines, requested they be able to use our guidelines once finished and share them with their departments in Ethnic, international, sociology, and education studies. All of this makes a strong case that there is a demand for self-citation guidelines from their target audience.

Establishing demand is a reasonably low burden of proof, but our team was able to establish that both students and teachers who used self-citation practices found them to be beneficial in fulfilling many different educational goals. “Students frequently mention what they remember most from a course [...] is not any particular reading, but the analytical tools they learn to apply to their own lives.”^[9] First and foremost, we believe that our guidelines are an essential addition to existing options because they are a tool which can be used in academia, and in daily life. It is no secret that what we are taught influences what we think, which in turn shapes the way we speak, act, and treat others. Our tool goes to the heart of that process in order to change the way we think about representation at each level. Without the integration of diverse lived experiences, we miss something. Rhetorical disconnection from subjects can, and has, led to dehumanization in policy and in greater society.^[10] Our guidelines offer a way to break down hierarchical constructs of expertise and deservingness to value knowledge beyond the credentials or job title attached to it. The archetype of the unbiased academic observer is a ruse. All people, scholars or otherwise, bring unconscious biases into any observation. Therefore it is important for students to practice acknowledging the way their experiences inform their work, and to allow subjects with lived experiences to speak for themselves. In this way, self-citation gives students the, “power to disrupt master narratives, and [...] exercise agency over their stories”^[11]

One student's use of the guidelines illustrates this ability particularly well. Julia^[12], a Mexican-American student cited her personal experiences, and the experiences of her family members in a paper about the U.S.-Mexico border. The experiences she cited stood as a counterpoint to the Immigration, Customs, and Enforcement website. She said,

“People don't have personal experience in the articles we read. But I can use [my personal experience] to make the case in my paper. The stuff I cite[ed, my] family experience is not what you would find in academic papers... It's important to represent how I experience the world because of my background.”

This student was able to subvert master narratives about the experiences of immigrants to broaden the scope of knowledge in balancing and humanizing ways that are essential to, and often lost in academic writings about immigration.

Instructors who had practiced allowing self-citation said that not only did students who used them come to respect the viewpoints of others more, but they often gained confidence in their own perspectives. This could indicate that as one shifts away from rigid, meritocratic conceptions of expertise in others, they may also become more open to the value of their own point of view. In this way self-citation accomplishes one of the most difficult challenges of education, particularly in social sciences: to not only change the way students think, but also the way they feel.^[13]

Our guidelines also align with more standard learning goals like student performance. Every single self-citation user interviewed noted the value of connecting subject matter to personal, or real life examples. One education scholar expressed that this connection runs deeper, and affects student performance as well stating that, “it is a truism in writing that students do better when connected to their work. [...] it's an evidence based teaching strategy [used] in many subjects.”^[14] The power of personal connection was further bolstered by the input of other professors, and students, as well as outside sources.^[15] Several students felt that integrating their own, or someone else's experiences motivated them to work harder, while other students described being more interested in the subject matter and driven to do more projects centering on the knowledge they created.^[16] One professor noted that students who use knowledge they created, “develop a stronger voice in their work and [...] are able to more deeply connect abstract theory, or aggregate-level characteristics to the micro-level”. Outside of our own research, a recent study surveyed undergraduate students, from several institutions asking students about what makes a writing assignment meaningful. The authors found that the existence of a personal connection between author and subject, or a connection to peers, family, or community were the most likely to have a meaningful impact on students.^[17] When students find work meaningful and engaging, they are more likely to retain the information and perform better.

Addressing the concerns of our target audience was the most important part of assessing our guidelines, and creating a living document that could be widely and easily used. Three broad concerns coalesced out of all those posed to our research team by interviewees. First, students and instructors wondered why these guidelines were necessary, second, many expressed concerns

about how to balance the risks of self-citation. Finally, students and instructors were both challenged by how to encourage students and instructors to use personal citation in the face of decades of classical western education which teaches students, “not to use I statements, because [they] detract from [an] argument.”^[18] We found that in reviewing feedback, those who had never considered allowing students to create their own knowledge, understandably raised the most questions about its viability, while students and professors who had used them bore insightful takeaways, and all expressed that they found the experience beneficial. One student stated that the guidelines allowed for the creation of a, “dialogue of people’s experiences”^[19] which we will attempt to create here as well.

The most prevalent concern of students and instructors was about how to balance the risks of self-citation. From one instructor who, “worr[ied] about the cooption of our guidelines by white supremacists [...and] holocaust deniers”^[20], to a student who said they might never use the guidelines because they feared unintentionally misrepresenting an interview subject, or over representing their own experience;^[21] Students were often challenged by the question of how to maintain credibility when integrating non-academic sources, and curtail bias in using personal data. These fears were most simply addressed by one professor who said that, “credibility is not an issue when it comes to self citation, because it is always a piece of evidence which requires further support.” It is essential for self-citation to be part of a discussion, to bring a greater variety of voices into conversation with one another, in order to enrich the research being done, rather than using it as the crux of an argument. Encouraging students to be conscious of their sources through source counting, or auditing for diversity of source type; or author gender, race, and educational attainment, are concrete ways to help students create balance in their use of sources.^[22] These skills are crucial when integrating any source into research, whether or not a source is self-cited. It is also important that the practice of self-citation be integrated into a course along with education about theory, knowledge production and the politics of citation so that students understand the necessity of creating balance among sources, and acknowledging biases in their writing. The course outline we created to accompany the guidelines provides instructors with some ideas and guidance on how to introduce self-citation responsibly.^[23] We also created consent forms in which students record the contact information of interviewees as another way to quell some fears about falsified data.^[24] At the same time, it is essential to note that many of the credibility risks one might attribute to self-citation already pervade the existing citation guidelines. Falsified data, misinterpreted data, skewed data, and bias are all issues which occur within the existing parameters.^[25]

Another major source of apprehension in using our guidelines was that many students have been conditioned against self-citation throughout their schooling. One student stated, “ It is so ingrained in my writing that I’m not supposed to use I statements, because it detracts from an argument, or isn’t considered as credible”.^[26] One instructor who uses self-citation in their classes offered an apt response, “ Students are often skeptical when [...] encourage[ed to] include such info[rmation], which I attribute to socialization into a very western-centric, classical education system that defines scientific knowledge and evidence in very narrow ways. I find that many students are interested in using this kind of data, but it is so far outside of their comfort zone that many don’t end up including it in their papers [...] but that is easily cleared up by providing guidelines.”^[27] The challenge of what students have been conditioned to believe through years of schooling is another reason why combining the introduction of the guidelines with education about the politics of citation, and knowledge production is essential. We encourage instructors to use suggested reading assignments, or conduct an in class discussion to take students where they are in understanding citation practices, and move towards less restrictive definitions of knowledge and expertise. Students are likely to feel some discomfort with such a change, so providing opportunities to ask questions and practice in class are important to give students the confidence and understanding to properly cite themselves. Using in-class writing workshops throughout the writing process, can also provide more apprehensive students with an opportunity to check in with one another and see how others are integrating knowledge they created. A more subtle side of students’ apprehension in using self-citation, is that many struggle to see the value in their own voices. Much of primary, secondary, and post-secondary education teaches students subjugation. The student is often situated as the object of information, and never a subject in communication.^[28] Encouraging students to go beyond their roles as the receivers of knowledge to its creators, requires actively engaging with and challenging student perceptions about the value of their experiences and communities. This work can yield students more confident in themselves, and prepare them to do independent, qualitative research work as their schooling progresses, and beyond.

The work we have done here creates a compelling argument for integrating self-citation practices into undergraduate education as well as lessons on knowledge production, and citation politics. However, our study was limited by a fairly small data pool, with feedback limited to instructors from only two universities, and students from one university. Moreover, the student feedback we received came from several courses with reasonably similar subject matter. To better understand the value of the practices we espouse in this article, we encourage our colleagues to pursue further research with larger and more diverse data sets. We are confident that there are many opportunities to expand upon and further support the claims we have made.

One potentially interesting and enriching avenue for further research in this area would be to explore some of the neuroscience behind what makes interviews and personal narratives powerful catalysts for learning and motivating people to act. Some research has been done on the power of personal narratives to change the brain. These studies focused on making effective public service announcements, or charitable campaigns, but researchers have yet to bring these ideas into academia. In one study of storytelling and brain chemistry, emotional stories caused the release of oxytocin in the brain which elicited an empathetic response in listeners. After the stories were told, listeners with higher levels of oxytocin were significantly more likely to make a charitable donation. Not only that, but those who had a neurochemical reaction to a personal story noted feeling more motivated, uplifted, and connected to those around them. If these outcomes hold true in an academic setting, then they form a strong argument for the integration of more educational practices that connect students to personal narratives for learning purposes.^[29]

1. Purdue Writing Lab. "Interviews, Personal Communication // Purdue Writing Lab." Purdue Writing Lab. Accessed June 28, 2021. [↵](#)
2. Purdue Writing Lab. "Interviews, Personal Communication // Purdue Writing Lab." Purdue Writing Lab. Accessed June 28, 2021. [↵](#)
3. Van Norden, Bryan W. *Taking Back Philosophy: A Multicultural Manifesto*. New York: Columbia University Press, 2017. [↵](#)
4. Chakravartty, Paula, Rachel Kuo, Victoria Grubbs, and Charlton McIlwain. "#CommunicationSoWhite." *Journal of Communication* 68, no. 2 (April 2, 2018): 254-66. Accessed June 29, 2021. Oxford Academic. [↵](#)
5. Baker, Lee D. *From Savage to Negro: Anthropology and the Construction of Race, 1896-1954*. Berkeley, Calif: University of California Press, 2007. [↵](#)
6. Delgado, Richard. "The Imperial Scholar: Reflections on a Review of Civil Rights Literature." *University of Pennsylvania Law Review* 132, no. 3 (March 1984): 561. Accessed June 20, 2021. doi:10.2307/3311882. [↵](#)
7. Mott, Carrie, and Daniel Cockayne. "Citation Matters: Mobilizing the Politics of Citation toward a Practice of 'conscientious Engagement'." *Gender, Place & Culture* 24, no. 7 (2017): 954-73. doi:10.1080/0966369x.2017.1339022. [↵](#)
8. Macdonald-Scott, Emma. WWU Instructor Survey on Students Citing Personal Experience(Google Form). April 2021.<https://docs.google.com/forms/d/1Y09sCn7pizHwPWtxeIzrsTMdTDuh7vPIpJMcsFkA4lw..>, & Macdonald-Scott, Emma. UW Instructor Survey on Students Citing Personal Experience(Google Form). January 2021. https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSfWtLqXac_LQlwOZ9sLUVwYIHPZV4yu8ZA3NGt-ZXl7Hf0yxw/viewform?usp=share_link. [↵](#)
9. Friedman, Kathie, and Karen Rosenberg. "Performing Identities in the Classroom: Teaching Jewish Women's Studies." *Teaching Sociology* 35, no. 4 (2007): 315-33. doi:10.1177/0092055X0703500402. [↵](#)
10. *ibid* [↵](#)
11. Pinedo-Turnovsky, Caroline (Professor at UW) interviewed by Macdonald-Scott, University of Washington, July 16, 2019 [↵](#)
12. Pseudonym [↵](#)
13. Friedman, Kathie (Professor at UW) interviewed by Macdonald-Scott, University of Washington, July 16, 2019 [↵](#)
14. Kalikoff, Beth (Professor at UW) interviewed by Macdonald-Scott, University of Washington, July 16, 2019 [↵](#)
15. Lerner, Neil, Michele Eodice, and Anne Ellen Geller. "The Power of Personal Connection for Undergraduate Student WritersThe Power of Personal Connection for Undergraduate Student Writers." *Research in the Teaching of English* 53, no. 4 (May 2019). Accessed June 2, 2021. ProQuest. [↵](#)
16. International Justice on Trial Students #5,6, & 10, Interviewed by Willard, University of Washington, 2019., Grad Student 1 (Graduate student Instructor using Citation Guidelines) Interviewed by Willard, University of Washington, 2019. [↵](#)
17. Lerner, Neil, Michele Eodice, and Anne Ellen Geller. "The Power of Personal Connection for Undergraduate Student WritersThe Power of Personal Connection for Undergraduate Student Writers." *Research in the Teaching of English* 53, no. 4 (May 2019). Accessed June 2, 2021. ProQuest. [↵](#)
18. International Justice on Trial Student #7, Interviewed by Willard, University of Washington, 2019. [↵](#)
19. International Justice on Trial Student #5, Interviewed by Willard, University of Washington, 2019. [↵](#)
20. Macdonald-Scott, Emma. UW Instructor Survey on Students Citing Personal Experience(Google Form). January 2021. https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSfWtLqXac_LQlwOZ9sLUVwYIHPZV4yu8ZA3NGt-ZXl7Hf0yxw/viewform?usp=share_link. [↵](#)
21. International Justice on Trial Student #6, Interviewed by Willard, University of Washington, 2019., International Justice on Trial Student #1, Interviewed by Willard, University of Washington, 2019. [↵](#)
22. Mott, Carrie, and Daniel Cockayne. "Citation Matters: Mobilizing the Politics of Citation toward a Practice of 'conscientious Engagement'." *Gender, Place & Culture* 24, no. 7 (2017): 954-73. doi:10.1080/0966369x.2017.1339022. [↵](#)
23. See course design [↵](#)

24. Thanks to Professor Kathie Friedman for the inspiration and for providing examples of her consent forms. ↩
25. Stern, Mark Joseph. "Groundbreaking Study on Shifting Attitudes Toward Gays Used Faked Data." Slate Magazine. May 20, 2015. Accessed June 28, 2021. <https://slate.com/human-interest/2015/05/science-study-that-showed-shifting-attitude-toward-gays-used-faked-data.html>. ↩
26. International Justice on Trial Student #7, Interviewed by Willard, University of Washington, 2019. ↩
27. Macdonald-Scott, Emma. UW Instructor Survey on Students Citing Personal Experience(Google Form). January 2021. https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSfWtLqXac_LQlwOZ9sLUVwYIHPZV4yu8ZA3NGt-ZXl7Hf0yxw/viewform?usp=share_link. ↩
28. Foucault, Michel. Discipline and Punish : the Birth of the Prison. First Vintage books edition. New York: Vintage Books, a division of Random House, 1979. ↩
29. Zak, Paul J. Paul J. "How Stories Change the Brain." Greater Good. December 13, 2017. Accessed February 28, 2021. https://greatergood.berkeley.edu/article/item/how_stories_change_brain. ↩

This page titled [1.5: Discussion and Reflections](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally](#).

1.6: Conclusion 1.6: ConclusionEdit Update titlecancel

6

Conclusion

[Emily Willard](#), [Emma Macdonald-Scott](#), and [Jake Lally](#)

Our hope is that this idea will continue to be improved upon by other groups and individuals. We recognize that in the last five years of working on the project that new work and interest in this type of work is advancing rapidly. The movement to make education and knowledge production more equitable and accessible to all people is ongoing and the hope is that this is a very small contribution.

The hope is that others will repurpose, reuse, copy and improve these guidelines, or even use the ideas discussed here to create entirely new guidelines.

These were developed and mainly used with undergraduate university students, however it would be important to explore the use of of these guidelines or similar ones for high school students, and graduate students. We provided the guidelines to a small group of graduate students and received feedback from one of the students who used it. Future work could collaborate with graduate students who want to use these guidelines or something similar in their own research and work.

This page titled [1.6: Conclusion](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard](#), [Emma Macdonald-Scott](#), and [Jake Lally](#).

1.7: The Guidelines 1.7: The GuidelinesEdit Update titlecancel

7

The Guidelines

Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally

PDF version of guidelines here: [Revised Guidelines 5-15-2023](#)

Guidelines to Citing Personal Experience and Interviews in Research

(Updated May 2023)

Purpose: The purpose of this document is to provide students with guidelines on how to cite personal and family experiences in their academic research to allow for the inclusion of more diverse forms of knowledge production.

Scholars are able to include data from participant-observation and ethnographic research methodologies in peer-reviewed publications. The credentials and academic training of the scholar is often what gives this personal, lived experience academic weight and authority. However, what if you don't have multiple degrees or even a university education? What if you have not been formally trained on research methodologies? Do your personal, lived experiences still have value in academic research?

These guidelines are proposed in an effort to move toward decolonizing the classroom in a practical way by making space for diverse forms of knowledge production by people who have lived experiences in the contexts we study, but also to make space for the forms of knowledge production that students—along with their communities and families—create as valuable parts of their research. Whether or not we have direct experience in a context we study, we all approach our research and study from a specific position or viewpoint. No matter what it is, it's important to consider who we are and be thoughtful about what lenses we bring with us.

These guidelines explain and provide examples of how to cite personal experience, and the proper structure of the citation, adapted from Chicago, APA, and MLA citation formats. This guide also provides information about how to cite personal interviews/conversations, including the importance of obtaining consent from the person you are interviewing.

Acknowledgements: These guidelines are inspired by Native scholars, and scholars of feminist, critical race, and post-colonial theory...all who in their own way argue for acknowledgement and inclusion of diverse forms of knowledge production, working to dismantle current power structures regarding who gets to produce knowledge and claim it as valuable or not. [See "Additional Reading Suggestions" section for more information.] These guidelines were originally developed for University of Washington LSJ 491 course and have been edited according to feedback from students who utilized them and is a part of an ongoing project with students to further develop these guidelines. Feedback welcome. Contact: Emily Willard, ewillard@gmail.com

How to Cite Personal Experience

In order to provide a space for more diverse forms of knowledge production, you are able to use your own personal experience as evidence for this assignment, as long as it is properly cited (see format below) and follows certain guidelines. The idea is that information you get from personal interviews, or what you know from personal experience is valid and can be used as evidence to support your argument. Using citations for personal experience and interviews should be a piece of the wider puzzle constituting your argument.

Guidelines: The personal experience you cite should serve as evidence to support your argument or provide background information that adds substance to your paper and is a unique perspective that would not be easily found through other sources. In other words, it is not ok to use personal experience as a "shortcut" to avoid doing research or citing other sources. It is important to avoid sweeping generalizations, and students should only use the citation to speak to the specific experiences. The main idea is that you need to explain your relationship to the information you are using in your paper. You need to explain to your reader how you know what you know.

Examples of not acceptable uses of citing personal experience:

Example 1:

"Poverty is a human rights issue in Latin America." (Personal Experience mission trip to Dominican Republic, June 2018)

Example 2:

“Transitional justice efforts in Cambodia have been unsuccessful in addressing human rights violations during the genocide.” (Personal experience of visits to Killing Fields Museum in Phnom Penh, and Angkor Wat Temple, Cambodia, June 2018).

Example 3:

“Drug violence is a severe, ongoing problem in Mexico, and is amplified by police corruption and lack of rule of law.” (Personal experience of visit to Cancun, Mexico and reading local Mexican newspapers, March 2018).

These are not acceptable uses of personal experience because:

- 1) They are overly generalized statements about complex issues, and the student provides no evidence of extensive conversations with people who are directly affected by these issues (for example personal interviews), a deep engagement with the issues at hand, or a close personal relationship to the issues discussed.
- 2) Their own viewpoints, as they are written, seem to come from disengaged, outside observer, and the way they describe their experience seems to come from a place of relative lack of understanding or knowledge of potentially complex issues. The student does not seem to consider their own viewpoint or position relative to what they are observing.
- 3) The information cited is widely available in other sources that can better illuminate complexities and details in each context.

Example of proper citation of personal experience:

Example 1:

“Even though many academics and practitioners argue that Guatemala is “post-conflict,” communities continue to suffer from on-going violence and unresolved conflict. Some civil society members argue that the violence is worse now than during the conflict because the perpetrator is not as clearly defined as a result of increasing influence of clandestine, organized criminal groups, and a lack of rule of law.” (Personal Experience human rights monitoring delegation with the Guatemala Human Rights Commission-USA, including meetings with civil society members, government officials, and informal interviews and conversations with people in Guatemala, in June 2018.)

Example 2:

“The emotional and psychological effects of forced disappearance contribute to intergenerational trauma in which generations of family members struggle with the lack of closure and lack of information about what happened to loved ones. When information is released, it can have a profound impact on healing this intergenerational trauma.” (Personal experience as family member of the disappeared in Paraguay, 1980s to present).

Example 3:

“Even 20 years after the end of the dictatorship and the inquiry by the truth and reconciliation commission, Chile remains divided politically between those who supported Pinochet, and those who don’t. For example, some families continue to support Pinochet’s dictatorship, arguing that the human rights violations were worth committing to save the country from economic ruin. Other people continue to mourn the loss of their friends and family, calling for more trials to hold perpetrators accountable for the human rights violations committed by the Pinochet regime.” (Personal Experience, study abroad living with a pro-Pinochet family, and conversations with friends who had family members disappeared, Santiago, Chile, August-December 2017.)

Example 4:

“In the 1960s-70s in the United States, women often had difficulties opening bank accounts, leading to increased vulnerability in domestic violence situations. This was the case because banks required a man, usually either a husband or father, to cosign a bank account in order for women to open one. This challenge was exacerbated for women of color and women who had recently immigrated due to racial discrimination. In some cases, this led to women’s inability to leave abusive relationships and support themselves and their children independently.” (Personal experience of family history in Charleston, South Carolina, USA, 1960s-1970s.)

Example 5:

“During the current political unrest in Nicaragua, people are suffering from a lack of access to food, medicine, and clean water due to roadblocks placed by dissident groups, and also by government rationing.” (Personal experience of visit to Nicaragua in June 2018 and conversations with family and friends in Managua, Nicaragua January – August 2018). [You could also supplement this with quotations from an interview with a specific family member or friend and cite it as a personal interview.]

These are acceptable uses of the citation guidelines because:

- 1) They are about specific experiences, anecdotes, or pieces of evidence to support an argument, not sweeping generalizations;
- 2) The specific information shared in the citation is not necessarily easily accessible in other sources;
- 3) In the cases where the student is a participant/observer, they explain the information presented is based on series of conversations with people directly affected and show their own understanding of some of the complexities of the situation, and their relationship to the information/topic.

Citation format (can be used of Chicago, APA, and MLA)

Use the following structure as footnotes or in-text citation. This should also appear as an entry in your bibliography. You may also be asked to include an annotation to the bibliography entry, explaining in more detail your relationship to the information you cite.

Structure: Personal Experience, [explain briefly what the experience was, how you gained the knowledge]. [Location], [if applicable, date/time-period].

Example: Personal Experience. Study abroad in the Netherlands attended meetings with civil society members and ICC officials, observed ICTY tribunal. The Hague, Netherlands, June-July 2018.

Example: Personal Experience. Growing up with parents who were undocumented immigrants from Somalia. Tulsa, Oklahoma, 1990s-present day.

How to Cite Personal Interviews

You can use the information gained through personal conversations or informal/formal interviews with friends, family, neighbors, etc. However, similar to citing personal experience, the information you choose to use should provide a unique perspective that would not be easily found through other sources and should not be used as a “short cut” to avoid doing other research. If you have a conversation at the dinner table with a family member/family member, cite it as an unpublished interview, using the structures below. If you recall stories over time from multiple family members, or a sort of family history, you may cite that as personal experience of conversations you had with family members over a period of time (see example 4 of how to cite personal experience).

When doing interviews with people who have experienced trauma, ensure that you let them lead the conversation regarding their experiences of trauma, and be sure to use active listening skills and respect their boundaries around what they feel comfortable talking about.

A note about consent: As with all research, it is important to get consent from the people that you interview in order to protect personal privacy, confidentiality, and identity as needed/requested. You should be clear with your interviewee about how you will use the interview material, and if you have permission to use their name. Always remember that the person you are interviewing can change their mind during the interview, and ultimately you need to honor their requests about what you do with their personal information. Use [this consent form](#), and turn a copy of it in with your paper – if appropriate. This may be too formal and legalistic in many cultures or communities, so use your best judgement and whatever is appropriate culturally in the community for obtaining free and informed consent.

If the person is no longer living and you would like to include the information, consider whether or not it would be appropriate to keep their identity confidential. If you are planning to do an interview, please speak to the class instructor first to get more detailed guidance about consent.

How to Cite an Unpublished Interview in Chicago/Turabian

Unpublished interviews are normally only cited in text or in notes, but if you include it an unpublished interview in a bibliography, the citation should include the name of the interviewee, the interviewer, some identifying information if necessary or appropriate, the place and date of the interview, and where a transcript or recording is available if it is.

Structure:

First name Last name of interviewee (identifying information), interviewed by First name Last name of interviewer at Location, Date.

Example: Prudence Bushnell (Former ambassador to Guatemala and Kenya), interviewed by Allison Henderson, New York, NY, July 2014.

Example:

Samprity and Arnab Pal (my great aunt and great uncle who lived in India during the partition and resettlement period of the late 1940s to early 1950s), interviewed by Allison Pal, New York, NY, July 2014.

How to Cite an Interview in APA

APA reference lists only include works that can be found by the reader. As a personal interview is not published or “findable,” it should not be included in an APA reference list. Instead, a personal interview should be referenced as a parenthetical citation. For example: (J. Smith, personal communication, May 17, 2008). If you would like to include a personal interview as part of your APA reference list, then include the interviewee, the date of the interview, and the type of interview. In your bibliography, you would need to include an approximately 75 to 100-word annotation explaining how this person knows the information they shared with you.

Structure:

Interviewee Last name, FI., interviewed by FI. Last name of interviewer(Year, Month date). Interview type .

Example:

López, A. interviewed by E. Willard(2014, July 29). Personal interview

Annotation: Aníbal López is my neighbor who moved to the United States from El Salvador during the 1980s in order to flee from violence during the Civil War. He was a union organizer and involved in public education campaigns in his hometown. Due to the violence against leftist organizers at the time, he feared for his life and the life of his family, so they fled El Salvador and have lived in the U.S. without documentation since that time. Aníbal is a leader in local immigrant rights groups, and owns his own business in Hyattsville, Maryland.

Citing a personal interview in MLA

Personal interviews refer to those interviews that you conduct yourself. List the interview by the name of the interviewee. Include the descriptor Personal interview and the date of the interview. In your bibliography, you would need to include an approximately 75 to 100-word annotation explaining how this person knows the information they shared with you.

Structure:

Last Name of Interviewee, First Name M., interviewed by FI. Last name of interviewer. Type of Interview [Personal Interview, Phone Interview, Skype Interview, etc.]. Date.

Example:

Henderson, Allison interviewed by E. Willard. Personal interview. 24 July 2014.

Annotation: Allison Henderson is an attorney who has worked as a federal public defender for the past 20 years, mainly representing children. She has represented several children who face immigration criminal charges, and frequently visits children being held in detention. Most of the clients she represents are located in the Pacific Northwest, and she has taken detailed notes about her observations of conditions inside the prison. She has worked with local and national human rights organizations to document human rights violations she has observed.

How to Incorporate into Your Paper

For the most part integrating self-conducted interviews should look the same as other pieces of evidence.

Avoid using “I statements” or breaking from the voice of the paper to insert interview information. Instead, draw out specific information from interviews that is relevant to the paper topic and argument you are making. This might also depend on the style of your writing – the main point is to keep it consistent throughout your paper

Avoid over-generalizing the experience of your interviewee or representing their experience as the norm unless you have established that this is true through the support of other sources. Additionally, stay as true as possible to the actual words and intent of interview responses. If you are unsure, it is always better to follow up with your interviewee than to make your own interpretations. Providing a small introduction to your interviewee before discussing the information they imparted can help more seamlessly integrate their contributions.

Example:

“Whenever the perpetrator of mass atrocity is the state, the integrity of that nation’s justice system is compromised, and trials can be used as a tool for perpetrating further injustice instead of alleviating it. This is the case in Turkey, as all trials regarding the conflict have been prosecuting Kurds for breaking extreme nationalism laws. Adar recalls a local bus driver in his hometown being

sent to jail for simply playing a Kurdish song (Adar). However, there are more prominent cases of this, perhaps the most famous being Leyla Zana, the first Kurdish woman to be elected to Turkey's parliament. During her oath to parliament in 1991, she said the required parts in Turkish and then added a...."

Additional Reading Suggestions

- Kishimoto, Kyoko. "Anti-Racist Pedagogy: From Faculty's Self-Reflection to Organizing within and beyond the Classroom." *Race Ethnicity and Education* 21, no. 4 (2018): 540–54.
- Million, Dian. "Felt Theory." *American Quarterly* 60, no. 2 (June 2008): 267–72.
- Mott, Carrie, and Daniel Cockayne. "Citation Matters: Mobilizing the Politics of Citation toward a Practice of 'Conscientious Engagement.'" *Gender, Place & Culture* 24, no. 7 (2017): 954–73.
- Smith, Linda Tuhiwai. *Decolonizing Methodologies: Research and Indigenous Peoples*. 2nd ed. London and Dunedin, N.Z.: Zed Books and University of Otago Press, 2012.
- Thomas, Robina Anne. "Honoring the Oral Traditions of the Ta't Mustimuxw (Ancestors) through Storytelling." In *Research as Resistance: Revisiting Critical, Indigenous, and Anti-Oppressive Approaches*, 177–98. Toronto: Canadian Scholars' Press, 2015.
- Tuck, Eve. "Suspending Damage: A Letter to Communities." *Harvard Educational Review* 79, no. 3 (2009): 409–428.
- Vizenor, Gerald. *Native Liberty: Natural Reason and Cultural Survivance*. Lincoln: University of Nebraska Press, 2009.

This page titled [1.7: The Guidelines](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard](#), [Emma Macdonald-Scott](#), and [Jake Lally](#).

1.8: Bibliography 1.8: BibliographyEdit Update titlecancel

8

Bibliography

Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally

Anker, Kirsten. "The Truth in Painting: Cultural Artefacts as Proof of Native Title." *Law Text Culture* 9 (2005): [v]-124.

Anonymous. (Graduate student Instructor using Citation Guidelines) Interviewed by Emily Willard, University of Washington, 2019.

Baumann, Dianne. "Blackfeet Men, 'Toxic Masculinity', and Gender Entanglement." Doctoral Dissertation, University of Washington, 2019. https://alliance-primo.hosted.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/f/1vbsh/TN_proquest2309529017.

Baker, Lee D. *From Savage to Negro: Anthropology and the Construction of Race, 1896-1954*. Berkeley, Calif: University of California Press, 2007.

Bishop, Russell. "Freeing Ourselves from Neo-Colonial Domination in Research: A Maori Approach to Creating Knowledge." *International Journal of Qualitative Studies in Education* 11, no. 2 (1998): 199–219. <https://doi.org/10.1080/095183998236674>.

Cammarota, Julio, and Augustine F. Romero. "A Social Justice Epistemology and Pedagogy for Latina/o Students: Transforming Public Education with Participatory Action Research." *New Directions for Youth Development* 2009, no. 123 (2009): 53–65. <https://doi.org/10.1002/yd.314>.

Carlie D. Trott, Laura B. Sample McMeeking & Andrea E. Weinberg (2019) Participatory action research experiences for undergraduates: forging critical connections through community engagement, *Studies in Higher Education*, DOI: 10.1080/03075079.2019.1602759

Chakravartty, Paula, Rachel Kuo, Victoria Grubbs, and Charlton McIlwain. "#CommunicationSoWhite." *Journal of Communication* 68, no. 2 (April 2, 2018): 254–66. Accessed June 29, 2021. Oxford Academic

Delgado, Richard. "The Imperial Scholar: Reflections on a Review of Civil Rights Literature." *University of Pennsylvania Law Review* 132, no. 3 (March 1984): 561. Accessed June 20, 2021. doi:10.2307/3311882.

Emerson, Robert M. "Writing Ethnographic Fieldnotes." *Chicago Guides to Writing, Editing, and Publishing*. Chicago: The University of Chicago Press, 2011.

Friedman, Kathie, and Karen Rosenberg. "Performing Identities in the Classroom: Teaching Jewish Women's Studies." *Teaching Sociology* 35, no. 4 (2007): 315–33. doi:10.1177/0092055X0703500402.

Foucault, Michel. *Discipline and Punish: the Birth of the Prison*. First Vintage books edition. New York: Vintage Books, a division of Random House, 1979.

Gerring, John. "Social Science Methodology: A Unified Framework." *Strategies for Social Inquiry*. Cambridge; Cambridge University Press, 2012.

Hall, Stuart. "When Was the 'Post-Colonial'? Thinking at the Limit." In *The Post-Colonial Question: Common Skies, Divided Horizons*, edited by I. Chambers and L. Curti, 242–60. New York: Routledge, 1996.

International Justice on Trial Students #1, Interviewed by Emily Willard University of Washington, 2019.

International Justice on Trial Student #5, Interviewed by Emily Willard, University of Washington, 2019.

International Justice on Trial Student #6, Interviewed by Emily Willard, University of Washington, 2019.

International Justice on Trial Student #7, Interviewed by Emily Willard, University of Washington, 2019.

International Justice on Trial Student #10, Interviewed by Emily Willard, University of Washington, 2019.

Kalikoff, Beth (Professor at UW) interviewed by Macdonald-Scott, University of Washington, July 16, 2019

Kindon, Sara, and Sarah Elwood. "Introduction: More than Methods-Reflections on Participatory Action Research in Geographic Teaching, Learning and Research: Participatory Action Research in Geographic Teaching, Learning and Research." *Journal of Geography in Higher Education* 33, no. 1 (2009): 19–32. <https://doi.org/10.1080/03098260802276474>.

- Kishimoto, Kyoko. "Anti-Racist Pedagogy: From Faculty's Self-Reflection to Organizing within and beyond the Classroom." *Race Ethnicity and Education* 21, no. 4 (2018): 540–54.
- Kovach, Margaret. *Indigenous Methodologies: Characteristics, Conversations and Contexts*. Toronto: University of Toronto Press, 2009.
- Lerner, Neil, Michele Eodice, and Anne Ellen Geller. "The Power of Personal Connection for Undergraduate Student Writers The Power of Personal Connection for Undergraduate Student Writers." *Research in the Teaching of English* 53, no. 4 (May 2019). Accessed June 2, 2021. ProQuest.
- Macdonald-Scott, Emma. WWU Instructor Survey on Students Citing Personal Experience(Google Form). April 2021.<https://docs.google.com/forms/d/1Y09...vPIpJMcsFkA4lw..>, & Macdonald-Scott, Emma. UW Instructor Survey on Students Citing Personal Experience(Google Form). January 2021. https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSfWtLqXac_LQlwOZ9sLUVwYIHPZV4yu8ZA3NGt-ZXl7Hf0yxw/viewform?usp=share_link.
- Million, Dian. "Felt Theory." *American Quarterly* 60, no. 2 (June 2008): 267–72.
- Moses, Robert, Mieko Kamii, Susan McAllister, and Jeffrey Howard. "The Algebra Project: Organizing in the Spirit of Ella." In *Critical Studies in Organization and Bureaucracy*, edited by Frank Fischer and Carmen Sirianni. Philadelphia: Temple University Press, 1984.
- Mott, Carrie, and Daniel Cockayne. "Citation Matters: Mobilizing the Politics of Citation toward a Practice of 'Conscientious Engagement.'" *Gender, Place & Culture* 24, no. 7 (2017): 954–73.
- Pinedo-Turnovsky, Caroline (Professor at UW) interviewed by Macdonald-Scott, University of Washington, July 16, 2019
- Purdue Writing Lab. "Interviews, Personal Communication // Purdue Writing Lab." Purdue Writing Lab. Accessed June 28, 2021.
- Rifkin, Mark. *Beyond Settler Time: Temporal Sovereignty and Indigenous Self-Determination*. Durham: Duke University Press, 2017. <http://site.ebrary.com/id/11333890>.
- Simpson, Audra. "On Ethnographic Refusal: Indigeneity, 'voice' and Colonial Citizenship." *Junctures: The Journal for Thematic Dialogue*, no. 9 (2007): 67.
- Smith, Linda Tuhiwai. *Decolonizing Methodologies: Research and Indigenous Peoples*. 2nd ed. London and Dunedin, N.Z.: Zed Books and University of Otago Press, 2012.
- Stern, Mark Joseph. "Groundbreaking Study on Shifting Attitudes Toward Gays Used Faked Data." *Slate Magazine*. May 20, 2015. Accessed June 28, 2021. <https://slate.com/human-interest/2015/05/science-study-that-showed-shifting-attitude-toward-gays-used-faked-data.html>.
- Stoler, Ann Laura. "Colonial Archives and the Arts of Governance: On the Content in the Form." In *Archives, Documentation, and Institutions of Social Memory: Essays from the Sawyer Seminar*, edited by Francis X. Blouin and William G. Rosenberg. Ann Arbor, MI: University of Michigan Press, 2006.
- Strega, Susan, and Leslie Brown, eds. *Research as Resistance: Critical, Indigenous and Anti-Oppressive Approaches*. Toronto, ON: Canadian Scholars' Press, 2005.
- TallBear, Kim. "Standing with and Speaking as Faith: A Feminist-Indigenous Approach to Inquiry." *Journal of Research Practice* 10, no. 2 (2014).
- Thomas, Robina Anne. "Honoring the Oral Traditions of the Ta't Mustimuxw (Ancestors) through Storytelling." In *Research as Resistance: Revisiting Critical, Indigenous, and Anti-Oppressive Approaches*, 177–98. Toronto: Canadian Scholars' Press, 2015.
- Tuck, Eve. "Suspending Damage: A Letter to Communities." *Harvard Educational Review* 79, no. 3 (2009): 409–28. <https://doi.org/10.17763/haer.79.3.n0016675661t3n15>.
- Tuck, Eve, K. Wayne Yang, and Rubén Gaztambide-Fernández. "Citation Practice Challenge." *Critical Ethnic Studies*, April 2015. <http://www.criticalethnicstudiesjournal.org/citation-practices>.
- Van Norden, Bryan W. *Taking Back Philosophy: A Multicultural Manifesto*. New York: Columbia University Press, 2017.
- Vizenor, Gerald. *Native Liberty: Natural Reason and Cultural Survivance*. Lincoln: University of Nebraska Press, 2009.

Zak, Paul J. Paul J. “How Stories Change the Brain.” Greater Good. December 13, 2017. Accessed February 28, 2021.
https://greatergood.berkeley.edu/art...s_change_brain

This page titled [1.8: Bibliography](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard](#), [Emma Macdonald-Scott](#), and [Jake Lally](#).

CHAPTER OVERVIEW

2: Classroom Tools

[2.1: Sample Syllabus](#)

[2.2: Consent Form](#)

[2.3: Course Design](#)

[2.4: Interview Best Practices](#)

This page titled [2: Classroom Tools](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard](#), [Emma Macdonald-Scott](#), and [Jake Lally](#).

2.1: Sample Syllabus 2.1: Sample SyllabusEdit Update titlecancel

9

Sample Syllabus

Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally

Important Notes:

- *Some of the hyperlinks in syllabus may not work because they are linked to private webpages for class discussion.*
- *The original syllabus from the year prior when the course conversations highlighted the need to create this citation guide. During this year, the citation guide was created and introduced mid-course for students to use in their final papers. See this original syllabus here: [SYLLABUS – LSJ 491 International Justice on Trial – Autumn 2018 FINAL](#)*

PDF version of sample syllabus here: [Syllabus LSJ 491 International Justice on Trial 2019 FINAL](#)

Full text version of sample syllabus below:

[LSJ 491: International Justice on Trial](#)

Autumn 2019

Course Introduction

This class will examine human rights civil and criminal trials at the domestic, transnational, and international levels, focusing specifically on how trials can be used as a tool of transitional justice and advance human rights, as well as the limits of trials in achieving justice. Topics explored will include the principle of universal jurisdiction, the right to information, immigration fraud cases, and what types of evidence present the strongest cases, among other topics. We will also consider alternative approaches to justice, drawing on Indigenous studies, and other non-Western ideas of what justice is and how to achieve it. Students will gain an understanding of these issues through various case studies of disappearances and massacres in Latin America, and genocide in Rwanda and Bosnia, and immigration fraud trials in the United States. This course meets the LSJ seminar and “rights” subfield requirement and serves as a writing credit.

The goal of the class is expose students to the variety of ways that judicial proceedings can be used to address human rights violations in attempt to achieve a sense of justice. Students will also be able to deeply interrogate the concept of justice itself, considering a multitude of ideas about what justice even is, and the strengths and limitations to using civil and criminal judicial proceedings to achieve these forms of justice.

Students are encouraged to think through the concept of justice, what justice means, and to whom. Students will analyze strengths and weaknesses of the international and state-level judicial systems, as well as explore alternative approaches to justice. This course is not designed to point you to any one “right” answer, but to provide you with tools to engage critically in the world around you, and to develop your own ideas and opinions.

Regardless of your political orientation, class background, profession, religious or ethnic identity, or citizenship status, *you are welcome in this class*. Please let me know how I can best foster an environment in which you feel comfortable participating as much as possible. Ideas of justice and how to address mass atrocity, human rights violations, and genocide are some of the most difficult questions our society faces, and I do not believe any singular (political, cultural, ethnic, or occupational) group holds the answers for how to solve them. We need a variety of voices and perspectives to join the conversation, and I will do my best to facilitate an open discussion, though I need your participation to help make this happen.

Requirements and Grading Policy

All students are expected to attend class meetings, complete all assigned readings, complete weekly online prompts, write a final paper, and participate actively in discussions in class.

Required readings

All readings are available through the class Canvas site in the “files” section. You do not need to purchase any materials for class. There is a reading guide nearly every week to help you practice your comprehensive reading skills. The idea is that you don’t need

to read every word of every reading – the most important thing is that you understand the main arguments and concepts in each reading. If you can answer the questions on the reading guide, you will likely have gotten the main points. Developing smart readings strategies is an important skill to learn that you can take into your future, especially as you take more advanced undergraduate courses, and especially if you go to grad school.

Grading

Your course grade will be assessed as follows: 10% participation in class discussions, 20% for weekly writing prompts based on course readings; and three written assignments for a total of 70%: role play essay 15%; a first draft of research paper 25%, and final draft of research paper 30%.

Each of the written assignments are out of 100 points and will follow a rubric provided with the prompt. The discussion sessions (one each class period) and weekly prompts are out of 10 points each.

For each of the three major written assignments, you will be graded based on the rubric, according to accuracy of content, and quality of content in your writing. We will review the rubric for each written assignment in class before it is due, and you will receive a copy of the rubric when you get your assignment back so you know how you earned the grade you got, and how you can make improvements.

10% of Grade: In-Class Discussion

To get full credit, you must participate in class discussion. Aim to share at least one thoughtful comment per class period. *This is a discussion seminar!* It is understood that people have different communication skills, so I will offer a variety of ways to participate, including large group and small group discussion and quick writes, but it is your responsibility to speak up. If you have concerns about this, please speak to me. I will post grades on canvas at the end of every week so you can track your grade.

20% of Grade: Weekly Reading Responses

Each week, students will be required to respond to a prompt about course readings on the canvas discussion page and include a question they had about the readings. Students must submit the reflection and question(s) by 10am the day of class, unless otherwise noted. Please pay attention to word count requirements for each prompt, they vary. To get full credit, you must include a word count at the end of each prompt.

These are relatively short and informal papers (500 words) in which you are invited to reflect on the readings and course themes. You should NOT summarize the readings, unless the question asks you to; it's safe to assume your reader will also have read them. What I want to know is what *you* make of them. Late response papers will not be accepted.

When a prompt refers to the “How to read an academic paper” Schema, it is referencing **THIS** which we review the first day of class. If you don't understand or are unclear about how to fill this out, see me BEFORE it is due. If you cannot access canvas for whatever reason, email me your response to the weekly prompt. “Canvas was not working” is not an excuse to turn weekly assignments in late. “I didn't understand” is also not an excuse. Do your best and we will review everything in class. Copying each other's work is not tolerated. If you copy each other's reflection assignments, you are cheating yourself out of a learning opportunity.

15% of Grade: Role Play Essay Assignment

This is a role play activity in which you take on a persona from a Latin American country that we have discussed and answer a series of questions in 1000-1200 words. The entire prompt will be posted in canvas at the start of the course. You will do a very short (3 minute) group presentation summarizing the variety of perspectives discussed in your group (you will be grouped with other people assigned your same persona). You don't all have to agree, no audio visual, and very informal! The idea is just to give the rest of the class what you wrote about and discussed.

- On Wednesday, October 9th, you will be assigned a persona in class.
- Monday, October 21st, you will have time in class to prepare your group presentation, and work on your written assignment.
- Wednesday, October 23rd, the written assignment is due in hard copy, and you will present (with your group) to the class for 3 minutes (this goes toward your in-class participation for the day).

25% of Grade: Rough Draft/Plan for Final Paper Assignment

Due Monday, November 11th at 11:59pm via canvas You must have your topic approved ahead of time, due via canvas by 10/29. You should not wait until this time to begin. You should be thinking about your topic and researching from the beginning of class.

You must write an *at least* 1000-word plan (either draft or substantive outline) for your final paper assignment that includes the following (consider this a grading rubric, it must have each of these components):

- Identification and brief summary of selected case (ideally this would be the introduction to your paper).
- What is your main argument? (What is your answer to the central prompt question?)
- What pieces of evidence do you anticipate using to make this argument? (Provide at least 5 pieces of evidence.)
- What are your preliminary (brainstorming) ideas for alternative approaches to justice?
- What additional sources will you use, specific to your case? (Provide at least 5 annotated bibliography entries.*)

This rough draft can be in the form of an extended/detailed outline or an actual draft of your paper. For the outline, it needs to include all of the parts mentioned above. If you are doing the actual draft option, it should have the points mentioned above, but incorporated into the draft. This is supposed to be helpful for you. If you are having trouble figuring this out, or have questions ask me. There is room for flexibility depending on your writing process. Let's talk.

You may also use the "how to read an academic paper" schema or an "outline" format to help you plan out your paper.

*An annotated bibliography summarizes the main points, research question, and conclusion of the source, and explains how it relates to your own argument. If you have more than five sources in your bibliography that's great! You only have to do annotations for five of them.

30% of Grade: Research Paper

DUE 12/10 at 4pm in LSJ office in *hard copy*, Smith Hall M253 (You may turn your final paper in earlier if you would like, please just make arrangements with me ahead of time.)

Final Paper Assignment 3,500 words (approximately 10-12 pages double spaced) answering the following two-part question:

1. **To what extent do the use of criminal and/or civil trials in achieve "justice" in human rights cases?** To answer this question, you must choose one case study* and explore the strengths AND weaknesses of the use of criminal and/or civil trials in this case. You must make a solid argument about the effectiveness in using criminal and/or civil trials in order to achieve justice in this case. In order to make a solid argument, you need to define what you think justice is, you need to argue your viewpoints, but you also need to identify and refute the arguments of the other side will use in making its own case.
2. Secondly, **Are there approaches to achieving justice beyond criminal and civil trials that you believe could be effective?** What recommendations do you make? This should address the weaknesses you identified in use of criminal and/or civil trials. You should identify alternatives discussed in class and think creatively about other ideas. You should use primary sources and secondary sources as evidence to make your case.

Do not count your footnotes or bibliography in the word count. For the final draft of your paper, your bibliography does not need to be annotated.

*You cannot choose Rwanda, Guatemala, El Salvador or Bosnia as your case study as we've discussed them in class, unless you want to deeply explore an aspect we have not discussed in class and conduct additional research on this other aspect – see me for approval of your final paper topic. Possible topics include: Cambodia, Sudan, Syria, United States, Argentina, Chile, Honduras, Northern Ireland, Iraq (see Samantha Power's book "[A Problem from Hell: America in the Age of Genocide](#)." for other ideas). You must submit your topic for approval no later than October 29th. You may submit it earlier.

You may select a topic that you have personal or family connection to, and you may use personal experience and/or personal interviews in the assignment. If you chose to do this, you need to follow the Personal Experience and Interviews Citation Guidelines [HERE](#). Please let me know if you have questions or want to discuss this further.

SUMMARY OF IMPORTANT ASSIGNMENT DATES:

- – Wednesday, October 9th – persona assigned in class (for role play assignment)
- – Monday, October 21st – in-class workshop for role play assignment
- – Wednesday, October 23rd – role play assignment due in class & informal group presentation
- – Tuesday, October 29th – Paper topic due via canvas by 11:59pm
- – Monday, November 11th – Rough Draft/Plan of final paper due via canvas by 11:59pm
- – Wednesday, December 4th – In-class paper workshop
- – Tuesday, December 10th – Final Paper due in hard copy in LSJ office, Smith Hall M253

Additional Notes

Course Material: Some of the material presented in this class may be disturbing. It is impossible to come to grips with the human rights history of the Americas without delving into accounts of torture, rape, and other violent acts. I understand that this can be particularly difficult for survivors of trauma. If you have been diagnosed with PTSD, you may want to consult an instructor for advance warning as to which readings, lectures, and films might include material you may find triggering. Please feel free to approach me about these concerns.

Class Bulletin Board: On canvas, there is a general posting board for you to share interesting, course-related information with your classmates. You can share events, news articles, resources, inspiring stories, links to movies or questions for your fellow classmates, for example.

Getting in contact with me: while Canvas may have a feature to send messages, I don't always get a notice if you send me a message, so the best way to contact me is by email: ewill@uw.edu, or to come see me in office hours

Word counts: Assignments are given in word count requirements; you must include a word count at the end of each assignment and try to stay within the general vicinity of the range. Points will be taken off if you do not include a word count. It is important for academic and general life skills to be able to write concisely and clearly and follow instructions.

Citations: You must always provide citations for information and words that are not your own ideas, including primary and secondary sources, as well as class discussions. You must choose a citation format and use it consistently, including page numbers. If you do not know how to cite a particular source, please consult me, or a reference librarian. You can use footnotes OR in-text citations with a bibliography.

If the assignment/information is related to your own personal experience, or the experience of your family or close friends or neighbors and you would like to use that information in your writing, please see the detailed guidelines for citing personal experience and interviews [HERE](#). If you are unsure about how to use these, or would like to discuss this further, please come talk to me.

Missing Class and Assignments: I do not take attendance (it is against UW policy), but there will be an in-class participation grade for each class session. In the event that I do use slide presentations, they will not be to the detail that I speak about in person, so you should make sure you talk to a classmate about getting their notes. This is a discussion seminar so most of the content of the class will be discussion-based and not a lecture. I may however provide short lectures at times.

As stated above, you cannot make up in-class participation except for extremely extenuating circumstances like personal or family emergency. If you miss class, you are responsible for knowing the material that was discussed. It is strongly encouraged that for whatever reason you plan (or don't plan) to miss a class or assignment, you email me (or any professor) prior to the class or deadline, let them know and ask if there is a way to make alternative arrangements – this is an important way that you can advocate for yourself, especially if you and/or your family are experiencing a crisis or emergency.

If you need an extension on an assignment, please let me know as in advance as possible. I will try to work with you, but please do not take advantage of my good faith attempt to be accommodating and giving you the benefit of the doubt. That's disrespectful to me, and to your classmates who work hard to make deadlines. If you need an extension due to personal or family emergency, please speak to me as soon as possible so we can work something out. If there are ongoing health issues, it is recommended that you consult [Disability Resources for Students \(DRS\)](#) to make formal arrangements.

Outside help: While each student must turn in unique assignments, representing only their own work, and plagiarism will not be tolerated, talking to a classmate about their ideas is encouraged, as is seeking guidance from the writing center to ensure you are expressing your ideas as clearly and strategically as possible.

Extra Credit Opportunities: You can sign up to give an Inspiration Presentation (IP) see guidelines [HERE](#). You will get an added 10 points to your participation grade for completing this (counts as one class period of discussion).

OR you may also sign up to give a current events presentation. They are the same as the IP guidelines, but need to be on a current event item that related directly to class material (international human rights trials or other non-trial pursuits of justice). Please get this topic approved before presenting.

You must email me to sign up for your presentation, available slots are first-come-first-serve. You can see the signup sheet and which slots are available on the designated discussion board [HERE](#) on Canvas.

There may also be other opportunities to attend events on campus throughout the quarter, announced by email and in class.

Resources

For help researching your long paper, please visit Emily Keller the Human Rights librarian at the UW library. For more information and to make an appointment with her, see: <http://guides.lib.uw.edu/research/emkeller>

Any student who has a need for special accommodation(s) in this class should contact the Disability Resource Center <http://depts.washington.edu/uwdrs/> and/or speak with me privately to discuss the specific situation.

The UW Counseling Center offers free and confidential short-term, problem-focused counseling to UW Students who may feel overwhelmed by the responsibilities of college, work, family and relationships. Counselors are available to help students cope with stresses and personal issues that may interfere with their ability to perform in school. To schedule an appointment, please call 206-543-1240 or stop by 401 Schmitz Hall. More information, including information about additional low-cost resources, is available at: <http://www.washington.edu/counseling/>

If you are concerned about yourself or others, contact **SafeCampus**: “The SafeCampus team is here for you. Tell us what’s going on and we’ll figure out how to best address your concerns. We work with campus partners to keep our community safe. If you’re scared or unsure what to do, call us.” Phone number: 206-685-7233. Online: <https://depts.washington.edu/safecamp/>

Course Outline: Assignments and Readings

All readings are available on Canvas under course files, and via links on the syllabus. All audio visual materials are provided as links on the syllabus. Students are not required to purchase any texts for this class. You should bring a copy of the readings to class to reference during discussion. Paper copy is ideal, but electronic is also permitted, though if it appears that people are doing other things with their electronic devices, they will be prohibited during class time.

Weekly assignments and readings subject to change. You will be notified of any changes through canvas, email, and/or announcement in class.

WEEK Zero: Course Introduction

9/25: Introduction & Discussion Activity

Readings: none

Weekly Learning objectives: Meet classmates and instructor, learn [how to read academic texts](#), prepare for course requirements and expectations, understand syllabus, and “citing personal experience and interviews” for final paper.

WEEK 1: What is justice and why are trials important?

9/30: Case of Dos Erres – *Finding Oscar*

Readings: [Minow \(1998\) *Between Vengeance and Forgiveness*, Introduction and Chapter 2 \(pgs. 1-24\)](#)

10/2: What is justice?

Readings: [Minow \(1998\) *Between Vengeance and Forgiveness*, Chapter 3 \(pgs. 25-51\)](#)

Assignment: Reflect on weekly readings and discussion. See canvas for prompt. Due 10/2 by 10am on canvas discussion board.

Weekly Learning objectives: critical analysis, demonstrate understanding of basics of concept of justice, and trials as a mechanism of justice.

WEEK 2: Civil versus Criminal– How to Achieve Justice?

10/7: Civil Trials

Readings:

- [Sikkink and Kim \(2013\) “Justice Cascade”](#)
- [Doyle \(2017\) “Creative Justice: Behind the battle to make U.S. courtrooms sites of accountability for Latin American human rights atrocities”](#)

10/9: Criminal Trials

Reading: Taylor (2003) *The Archive and the Repertoire*, Chapter 6

Assignment: “How to read an academic paper” Schema, fill out for Sikkink and Taylor readings. Due 10/9 by 10am on canvas discussion board.

Weekly Learning Objectives: Understand the difference between civil and criminal approaches to human rights issues; think critically about concept of justice and how criminal and civil cases address it differently. Demonstrate understanding of concept of “justice cascade.”

WEEK 3: Domestic Trials

10/14: Guatemala Genocide Case

Readings:

- Burt (2016) “From Heaven to Hell in Ten Days”
- Velasquez-Nimatuj & Aguilar – “Art as memorialization” excerpt from “Inhabitation of Loss” (only 2 pages)
- Velasquez-Nimatuj – “Struggles and Obstacles in Indigenous Women’s Fight for Justice in Guatemala” (only 4 pages)

Recommended Reading: Center for Justice and Accountability “Justice in Guatemala”

10/16: United States – Immigration Fraud

Readings: News media on immigration fraud cases

- Muyenyezi Case, McPhee (2015) *Boston Magazine*
- Jordan Case, Doyle (2010) “Wrenching Testimony and a Historic Sentence”
- Montano Case, Willard (2012) “El Salvador Ex-Military Pleads Guilty”

Recommended reading: *United States vs. Muyenyezi* court decision (2015)

Assignment: Assign Role Play persona on 10/14 in class. See reading response prompt on canvas.

Weekly Learning Objectives: critical thinking about what justice is, and from perspectives of perpetrators, family members, victims, international community, and bystanders.

WEEK 4: Transnational Human Rights Cases – Trials in a Global Political Context

10/21: Case study of the Jesuit Case – Universal jurisdiction

Reading: Roht-Arriaza (2005) *The Pinochet Effect*, [preface](#) and [Chapter 1](#)

10/23: Are Perpetrators Savages?

Reading:

- Mutua (2001) “Savages, Victims, Saviors” – Excerpt ([full article HERE](#) is optional)
- Zion, James (2005). “Punishment versus Healing: How Does Traditional Indian Law Work?” in *Justice as Healing: Indigenous Ways*.

Assignments: Role Play activity workshop in class on 10/21.

Role play essay due on 10/23 in class, and short, informal group presentation on assignment.

See brief reading response prompt on canvas, due 10/23 at 10am.

Weekly Learning Objectives: critical thinking about what justice is, and from different perspectives, reinforce justice cascade

WEEK 5: Genocide Tribunals: International Courts of Justice or Injustice?

10/28: ICTR, ICTY, ICC and their limitations

Reading: Watch the following Tribunal Voices interview excerpts and pick at least 5 additional ones to watch. (They are short, almost all are 2 minutes or less.) Available from: <http://www.tribunalvoices.org/voices/>

- Roland Adjori, Senior Legal Advisor: “the Tribunal’s quest for justice”

- Alessandro Caldarone, Senior Officer: “the victims of the Genocide”
- Adama Dieng, Registrar: “retributive and restorative justice”
- Avp Fadugba, Chief of Information & Evidence: “emotional reaction to the evidence” and “the role of the evidence section in the terms of exculpatory material”
- Philippe Larochelle, Defense Counsel: “rationale for the ICTR” and “missed opportunities to fight a culture of impunity”
- Beth Lyons, Defense Counsel: “one-sided justice” and “lack of principle at the prosecution office” and “definitions of genocide”
- Francois Bembatoum, Chief Interpreter: “the difficulty of giving faithful renditions of witness testimony”
- Colette Ngoya, Translator: “the tribunal’s existence as progress”
- Alfred Kwende, Chief of Investigations: “the challenges of investigating genocide”
- Dennis Byron, President and Judge: “factual historical record”
- Angeline Djampou, Chief Librarian: “empowering people with information”

Read the following, short article: Humphrey (2003) “International intervention justice and national reconciliation the role of the ICTY and ICTR in Bosnia and Rwanda”

Submit final paper topic for approval, via canvas on 10/28. Start working on the rough draft of your paper now!

10/30: Genocide Trial in the U.S.A?

Reading:

- Vizenor (2009) *Native Liberty*, Chapter 6: Genocide Tribunals (pgs. 131-157).
- Alexie (2017) *Excerpts from Memoir You Don’t Have to Say You Love Me*. à Focus on the poem and pages 392-394 of chapter 147. (pages 382-391 are provided for context, but not required reading.)
- Review “Salish School of Spokane” website: <http://www.salishschoolofspokane.org/>

Recommended Reading: Review the Interior Salish curricula website here: <http://www.interiorsalish.com/home.html>

EXTRA CREDIT OPPORTUNITY: Attend the talk by Philip Deloria at 7:30pm in Kane Hall (prior registration required) See more info. [HERE](#).

Assignment: See short reading reflection prompt on canvas.

Weekly *Learning Objectives*: Gain an understanding of international criminal court and tribunals, think critically about what justice is and how these international mechanisms achieve justice or not, and for whom. Consider the role of the United States government as perpetrator of Genocide and what justice might look like in this case.

WEEK 6: Access to information – The FOIA, Declassified Documents, and evidence in cases of forced disappearance

11/4: Cases of forced disappearance

Reading: Kovras (2017) *Grassroots Activism and the Evolution of Transitional Justice*, Chapter 4 and Chapter 5 (pgs. 84-126)

Recommended Reading: Kovras (2017) *Grassroots Activism and the Evolution of Transitional Justice*, Chapter 3

11/6: Access to Information & Justice in Guatemala

Readings:

- Watch *To Eco the Pain of the Many*, a film by Ana Lucia Cuevas, <https://vimeo.com/37979362>
- Read Grinberg Pla (2016) “Filming Responsibly”

Assignment: Reading Response, see prompt on canvas. Due 10am 11/6.

Weekly *Learning Objective*: Gain an understanding of the relationship between the crime of forced disappearances and access to information. Opportunity to speak with the film-maker Ana Lucia Cuevas via video chat.

Rough Draft/Plan for Final Research Paper Assignment DUE Monday 11/11 at 11:59pm on canvas.

WEEK 7: Evidence – Documents and Eyewitness Testimony

11/11: Veteran's Day, No Class but rough draft of final paper due at 11:59pm via canvas.

11/13: Eyewitness Testimony & Knowledge Production

Reading:

- Stoler (2006) "[Colonial Archives and the Art of Governance](#)" (pgs. 267-279) SEE READING GUIDE, HERE!

Assignment: See prompt on canvas. Please bring the assignments to class for further discussion, in hard copy. Turned in for credit at the end of class.

Weekly Learning Objective: Able to critically engage declassified government documents, and understand how both documents and eyewitness testimony can serve as evidence in human rights trials.

WEEK 8: Evidence – Satellite Images & Maps

11/18: Satellite Images

Readings:

- Maron (2017) "[How Satellite Images Can Confirm Human Rights Abuses](#)"
- Snow (2012) "[Pentagon Satellite Images](#)"
- Eric Benn Expert Witness Testimony, [Trial Transcript, February 29, 2012](#) (focus on pgs. 17-35)
- Eric Benn Expert Witness Testimony, [Trial Transcript, February 12, 2013](#) (focus on pgs. 39-53)
- NGA Satellite Images ([exhibits in Benn Testimony](#))

Recommended Reading: Hamilton (2011) "[U.S. Opposition to International Criminal Court in 2004-2005 Held Up Peacekeeping, Slowed Justice for Genocide Perpetrators](#)"

11/20: Maps

Reading: Anker (2005) "[The Truth in Painting: Cultural Artifacts as Proof of Native Title](#)" – excerpt (pgs 145-166) ([full article HERE optional](#))

Assignment: See prompt on canvas – bring hard copy to share with class.

Weekly Learning Objective: Understand the role that satellite images and maps can serve as evidence in human rights trials. Challenge ideas of what kinds of evidence are "more true" than others.

WEEK 9: Evidence – DNA

11/25: DNA

Readings:

- Snow, Stover, and Hannibal (1989) "[Scientists as Detectives Investigating Human Rights](#)"
- Doyle (2011) "[Remains of two of Guatemala's Death Squad Diary victims found in mass grave](#)"

11/27: Thanksgiving Holiday – No Class!

Assignment: Work on final paper. No reading response this week.

WEEK 10: Returning Archives & Land

12/2: Returning Archives and Land

Reading: Wareham (2008) "[‘Our Own Identity, Our Own Taonga, Our Own Self Coming Back’: Indigenous Voices in New Zealand Record-Keeping](#)"

Recommended Reading: Tuck and Yang (2012) "[Decolonization is not a metaphor](#)"

Extra Credit: Write a reflection on the Tuck and Yang reading of approximately 250 words. Do you agree with them about returning land? Why or Why not? Turn in via canvas – see prompt. You will get an extra 10 points toward your reading response grade. If you have a perfect score, it will get added on top, helping your overall grade.

12/4:In-class paper workshop

(see canvas for more information)

Assignments: No reading response this week.

Final Paper: DUE Tuesday 12/10 at 4pm in LSJ office IN HARD COPY, Smith Hall M253.

This page titled [2.1: Sample Syllabus](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard](#), [Emma Macdonald-Scott](#), and [Jake Lally](#).

2.2: Consent Form 2.2: Consent FormEdit Update titlecancel

10

Consent Form

Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally

Note: Usage of this consent form is not necessarily appropriate in all contexts and situations and may vary by culture. Use your own best judgement, knowledge, and experience about what is the most appropriate and ethical way to gain consent from the person you are speaking with. The main goals of consent are that: 1) the person understands that you may or may not be doing an audio recording, or taking notes during the conversation; 2) how you plan to use the information the person shares; and 3) if the person wishes to be identified, and if so, how, as well as if they wish to remain unidentified/anonymous. It is also a good idea to make sure the person has your contact information or a way to get in touch with you if they have any questions post-interview.

PDF version of consent form available here: [Interview Consent Form \(September 2019\)](#)

INTERVIEW CONSENT FORM

My name is _____ and I am a student at the University of Washington. I am participating in a course where we are studying international human rights and justice. Students in the class are given the option of interviewing people that have personal experience related to their research topics as a part of our learning experience.

Your name and other identifying information will be kept confidential—only my professor and I will know it. You may hear in advance the list of questions I will ask you, and you may choose not to answer any question you wish. I would like to record the interview because it is easier to follow your story and get it down right if I don't have to take notes and ask questions at the same time. However, if you prefer, I will not record. Do I have your permission to proceed?

Yes, you may proceed and record the interview _____

No, you may not record the interview _____

If you agree to this interview, please fill out this form so that I may provide verifying information to the professor who is teaching the class.

Respondent's Name _____

Email Address _____

If you need more information about this project, you may contact my instructor, Emily Willard at the Henry M. Jackson School of International Studies, University of Washington. You can reach her at [phone number] and ewillard@uw.edu.

Thank you very much for agreeing to participate!

This page titled [2.2: Consent Form](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally](#).

2.3: Course Design 2.3: Course DesignEdit Update titlecancel

11

Course Design

Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally

The importance of the guidelines is, in part, rooted in the lesson of the guidelines, so the way that they are introduced is impactful. Feel free to take or leave any parts of this outline to fit your class. Keep in mind during discussion that the two primary goals of the guidelines are to integrate a wider variety of perspectives into academic writing/research, and to connect students personally and actively to their work/subject matter. Try to make clear connections to specific course subject matter, and introduce the guidelines early on in the class calendar to provide time to find interviewees.

Reorient the classroom: if possible arrange desks in a discussion circle, or find a way for students to be able to see each other rather than only the instructor

Name the dynamic: It may help some students feel more comfortable participating to explicitly state that the goal of the discussion will be for students to learn from each other. The instructor will guide the discussion rather than lead it.

Begin the discussion by meeting students where they are. These questions should help students understand the value of expanding citation practices before learning how to implement them.

1. What have you learned through your schooling about what gives a source value or makes it credible in academia?
2. What is the purpose of citing, and what does formally citing a source say about that source?
3. What is “truth”? Who determines what “the truth” is? Is it possible to have more than one truth?
4. When writing research papers how much value do you think your personal experience has?
5. If you have personal experience with a topic or know someone who does, how comfortable would you feel integrating that information into an assignment/project?
6. Do you think scholarly standards limit the number or variety of voices which can be heard on X topic we are discussing in class?
7. How do you think X topic could benefit from the voices of those who potentially lack formal or official credentials, but which might otherwise give their voices scholarly value?
8. What hierarchies can you observe within citation practices?

Introduce the guidelines to the class. Read through the ‘How to’ section together and take time to show examples of appropriate and inappropriate use, ask students, and discuss: what distinguishes them?

Check in: Ask students about their interest in using, and initial reactions to the guidelines.

Get critical: dive into questions and criticisms (understanding potential problems is crucial to understanding proper use).

- What problems could potentially arise from expanding citation?
- How is information from non-traditional sources integrated into assignments?
- How are non-traditional sources introduced and identified? Are they treated differently than peer-reviewed sources? Why or why not?

Talk about Positionality:

1. Example: What potential problems might arise if a white student were to study abroad in S. Africa and write a paper discussing apartheid?
2. If a white student did want to write about a study abroad trip to South Africa, how could they incorporate their own experience into a paper about apartheid that takes into consideration their own positionality?
3. What questions can we ask ourselves in order to ensure we are staying critical of our position as researchers if we are discussing the experiences of a community that is not our own?
 1. How does my identity affect the way I experienced a situation or how an interviewee responds to my questions?
 2. How might my past experiences impact the way that I am interpreting a situation?
 3. Imagine a third person perspective, and question where you might be over-extrapolating/reading into things versus communicating the actual concrete words of your interviewee.

4. STAY CRITICAL – and ask for second opinions
4. If we are basing evidence off of our own experience how can we ensure that we are not over generalizing or speaking for an entire community based on individual or narrow experience?
 1. discuss the role of supporting data/evidence – personal citation is meant to enrich your argument, make the information personal and nuanced, but to complement other sources – this does not however mean that they have to agree with one another.

Review interview best practices sheet and consent forms

Activity:

1. Have students break into small groups (4-6 people)
2. Brainstorm – get everybody on the same page- What are some topics in which you could use your own experience or know of someone whom you could interview to enrich discussion of that topic? Write down an idea or a few then share with group.
3. Each group shares one idea with the class – poll the other groups: Does this work?
4. Each group chooses an idea to flesh out further:
 1. come up with a quote, real or made-up that could be used as evidence for your idea
 2. Write a single paragraph embedding the quote or the sentiment of the quote
 3. Properly cite the quote using the guidelines
5. Groups can share their work with the class again for feedback

Summarize today's lesson, ask the class for feedback, and ask if there are questions

This page titled [2.3: Course Design](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard](#), [Emma Macdonald-Scott](#), and [Jake Lally](#).

2.4: Interview Best Practices 2.4: Interview Best PracticesEdit Update titlecancel

12

Interview Best Practices

Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally

PDF version available here: [Interview Best Practices](#).

Interview Checklist

- ☐ Introduce yourself, explain why you chose your interviewee (a little flattery always helps break the ice), and your overall goal in interviewing
- ☐ Provide an estimate of interview duration and ask if there is a hard cut off time
- ☐ Explain who will have access to the information obtained in the interview.
- ☐ Review and provide consent form for signature
- ☐ Ask if it's ok to record the interview
- ☐ Let your interviewee know they can break or stop at any time, and there are no wrong answers.
- ☐ Ask how they feel about everything and if there are any questions before beginning

Interview Best Practices/ Helpful Hints

- Ask for show and tell or bring photographs/objects that can aid the conversation
- Come prepared with questions, but listen to your interviewee – engage their responses, and try to make the discussion conversational whenever possible
- Take Notes!
- If a response is abrupt or unclear, inquire: “Can you tell me more about that?”
- Show interest
- Gain context with questions like: ‘How typical do you think that was?’

This page titled [2.4: Interview Best Practices](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally](#).

CHAPTER OVERVIEW

3: Open Data

[3.1: Course Evaluation Notes](#)

[3.2: Notes from Interviews with Students \(2018\)](#)

[3.3: Notes from Interviews with Students \(2019\)](#)

[3.4: Notes from Interview with Graduate Student \(2020\)](#)

[3.5: Notes from Interviews with Professors and Instructors](#)

[3.6: 2019 Praxis Presentation](#)

This page titled [3: Open Data](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard](#), [Emma Macdonald-Scott](#), and [Jake Lally](#).

3.1: Course Evaluation Notes 3.1: Course Evaluation NotesEdit Update titlecancel

13

Course Evaluation Notes

Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally

The following are notes written by Emily from course evaluations from the three courses where the guidelines were used. They were used in the two years Emily taught “International Justice on Trial” and the one summer she taught “Human Rights in America.”

Below are excerpted quotes from responses to questions Emily put on the evaluations. The course evaluations were required for each course and the instructor had the option to add questions in addition to the required questions about the course. This question was added to evaluate the use of the citation guidelines in each of the three course evaluations:

Was it helpful to allow for citing personal experience and interviews in your assignments? Are there ways to improve this?

See responses below.

Notes from Evaluations

Course: LSJ 2018

N = 21 Students out of 23 participated in evaluation

This is the first time the guidelines were used, emerged organically mid-course during discussions particularly when talking about eye-witness testimony, the challenges of what is presented in declassified documents, and Gerald Vizenor’s reading on 4th person.

Suggested Improvements:

1. Preface/warning about interviewing people who have experienced trauma.

Quotations:

“I think this form of citing allows individuals who have partaken in certain forms of justice, or have experienced the injustice first hand a platform for sharing their information. I think this type of citation is helpful for making the paper even more meaningful for some people, which may lead to overall better quality of papers.”

“It was helpful because it allowed me to expand my idea of what qualifies as evidence and it tied directly into the conversations we were having in class. I really appreciated that the professor noted how it would be hypocritical to discuss this and not allow us to cite our own experiences because it really legitimized her arguments and the discussions we had in class.”

“I appreciate the fact that the professor is trying to disrupt our traditional understandings of what evidence looks like.”

“I thought it was a really profound idea, and just having it as an option felt right and follows a theme of this class about exploring more open-minded ways to understand truth and evidence.”

“I think the best way to learn is by doing and tying in one’s own experiences with the course content is crucial for maintaining knowledge.”

“It wasn’t personally helpful, but I’m sure it could be for someone with experience that relates. I also think it was very forward thinking after learning about knowledge production.”

“Personally, I do not have life experiences that are very applicable for my paper or are more valid than opinions from scholarly sources. I think this form of citing allows individuals who have partaken in certain forms of justice, or have experienced the injustice first hand a platform for sharing their information. I think this type of citation is helpful for making the paper even more meaningful for some people, which may lead to overall better quality of papers.”

“Yes, especially the interviews were helpful to be able to cite since we did them in class. I will not be using personal experience in my paper but I think it is a really cool thing to be able to include given the topics in class.”

“Yes it was. I feel like not a lot of us have had personal connections to people effected by the topics we chose to right about.”

"I personally won't be using personal experience on the final paper, mostly because I am unfamiliar with doing so. However, I appreciate the fact that the professor is trying to disrupt our traditional understandings of what evidence looks like."

"Even though I may not cite personal experiences, it is helpful because it allows for the writer to be more entrenched in what they are writing. It is hard because a lot of this is based on trust; however, the professor built up a great reputation with her class and I feel as though we all respect her too much to take advantage of her trust."

"yes! I think its great to be able to include personal experience, those are some of the best conversations!"

"I didn't site personal experience or interviews in the final paper."

"This didn't personally apply to my paper, but I thought it was a really profound idea, and just having it as an option felt right and follows a theme of this class about exploring more open-minded ways to understand truth and evidence."

"Yes it is, I think the best way to learn is by doing and tying in one's own experiences with the course content is crucial for maintaining knowledge"

OWN [Emily's] REFLECTIONS:

Talk about neighbors, (examples?) encourage people to realize the value of voices of people are in our communities. (people talk about this: "feel like not a lot of us have had personal connections to people effected [sic] by the topics we chose to right [sic] about."

Notes from Evaluations

Course: LSJ 2019

N = 19 Students out of 25 participated in evaluation

This was the second time that the guidelines were used in the course, after considerable editing of the guidelines, and were introduced from the beginning.

Suggested improvements:

- Make expectations more clear
- Need to work more on how this is applicable to everyone in the class

Quotations:

"Yes, I think that is a valuable thing. It is important to watch out and ensure that people don't use it as an opportunity to do no work however. Just make expectations of how citing personal experience should be clear."

"I think it was helpful and allows for the class to learn from different peoples experiences as well as expand their own perspectives on subjects."

"Didn't affect me"

"Yes, however, while they provided a clear place to consider the opinions and interpretations of those around us, they were not always very practically applied to the assignments."

"I don't really have any relevant personal experience or interviews so I have no opinion on this"

Notes from Evaluations

Course: HRLA (Human Rights in Latin America) Summer 2018

N = 20 Students out of 21 participated in evaluation

This is the first time the guidelines were used in this course, Human Rights in Latin America. This class was taught by Emily during the summer. The course was developed by Dr. Angelina Godoy and Emily adapted the course and introduced the guidelines for students to use in course assignments, but they were considerably different than the LSJ assignments and course. There were not as deliberate conversations about knowledge production. .

Quotations:

"Although I did not do this I think it could add a lot of value to a person's work if they wanted to do this"

“Yes, this was, it allowed for deeper meaning and connection especially when talking about real-life events.”

“Yes it was. It made the concepts very palatable, and easier to remember when we could apply them to our own lives, or find personal examples, or hear personal examples from classmates.”

“Yes it was super helpful and insightful because we were able to learn more about the experiences that other went through.”

“ Yes, I think when you are allowed to make personal connections, the assignment itself has a greater meaning”

“ It did not matter to me because I do not really have any personal experience about the content”

This page titled [3.1: Course Evaluation Notes](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally](#).

3.2: Notes from Interviews with Students (2018) 3.2: Notes from Interviews with Students (2018)Edit Update titlecancel

14

Notes from Interviews with Students (2018)

Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally

The following are notes taken when Emily interviewed students following the first use of the citations guidelines in the class “International Justice on Trial” taught in Autumn Quarter of 2018. The interviews were conducted via telephone in January of 2019 after the end of the quarter and after grades had been turned in and distributed to students. Emily obtained informed consent from all of the participants for her to take notes and use the information shared in this ongoing project to improve the guidelines. Emily also obtained consent to anonymously use excerpts of the students’ papers in future publications or presentations. The notes have been anonymized to protect student privacy. These notes include both questions asked and responses.

Interview Questions with Selected Students

Summary:

Number of students Interviewed: 10

Number of students who used personal or family experience: 2

Number of students who used personal interviews: 3

Students who used neither: 5

I spoke to all of the students who used personal interviews/experiences. I selected the students who did not use the guidelines by those with whom I had more of personal relationship, i.e. those that came to officer hours, that spoke to me at length about their papers during the course, and engaged readily in class discussion. A limitation of this is that it would also be important to talk to the students who were less engaged to try to better understand why.

Who used the citation:

Student #1 (personal experience)

- What was your family experience, why did you choose to cite it? Why did you not cite it more specifically? How did (?) this affect how and why you wrote your paper?

Student #2 (personal family experience)

- Why did you choose to cite your family experience? How did this affect how you felt about your work on your paper? How did (?) this affect how and why you wrote your paper?

Student #3 (personal interview)

- Why did you choose to do the interview? (had you already done it or did you do it for the paper?) How did this affect how you felt about your work on your paper? How did (?) this affect how and why you wrote your paper?

Student #4 (personal interview)

- Why did you choose to do the interview? (had you already done it or did you do it for the paper?) How did this affect how you felt about your work on your paper? How did (?) this affect how and why you wrote your paper?

Student #5 (personal interview)

- Why did you choose to do the interview? (had you already done it or did you do it for the paper?) How did this affect how you felt about your work on your paper? How did (?) this affect how and why you wrote your paper?

Who didn’t use the citation but could have (known personal experience based on student sharing):

Student #6

- Why did you not cite your personal experience/interviews for this paper?
- Do you have any suggestions for improvements to the guidelines?

Who did not use the citation and didn't (to my knowledge) have personal experience related to their paper topic:

Student #7

Student #8

Student #9

Student #10

- Did you know you could cite personal interviews for your paper?
- Why did you not cite your personal experience/interviews for this paper?
- Can you imagine a situation in which you would cite your personal experience/interviews? What would it look like?
- Is there a way to make you more likely to do it?
- If you had the opportunity again in the future would you consider doing it?
- Do you have any suggestions for improvements to the guidelines?

Interview notes with the students:

Student #2

Why did you choose to cite your family experience?: “don't want to make broad statements without evidence unless you back it up. People don't have personal experience in the articles we read – reference through my eyes, and how i interpret it, i can make the case in my paper.” The stuff I did cite through family experience is not what you would find in academic papers, important to represent how I experience the world because of my background.”

It was really helpful – creating a dialogue, but then this is my own voice if I didn't have source. Would have had to cut out a lot of my paper because I didn't have source. Went on trip and family told me thinks

Times in life you learn a lot of things, some of the best perspectives you've ever heard, you don't always remember, not always learn through academia.

How did this affect how you felt about your work on your paper? Made my work more my own. Instead of reiterating everything I'm reading in the articles. Instead of just retelling, making my own point. No one else could be credited with portions of my paper because it came from me. Could use own voice. Not worried about personal – seeing the world.

How did (?) this affect how and why you wrote your paper? Yes- the topic I chose is related to what I care about

If i couldn't use my own personal experience I could have chosen any topic and it didn't make any difference.

Did you research differently? – no still had to find unbiased research to make my points, in discussion I was able to look at the research I had found, but then in discussion I was able to use my own points.

How to make better? Sheet was helpful, between confused own personal interpretation versus event that occurred. Directly cite I had gone somewhere, learned info from people on a trip. How interpreted world because of who I am and my experiences – broad how interpreted the world through my own personal experience. Because of my family – should have shortened it – personal experience. In-text citations – confusing?? Event vs. outlook on the world.

Student #1

Why did you choose to cite your family experience?

I chose to cite it because I could convey – it felt better that i could cite what I know and personally instead of someone else's source to back it up. Validation for own experience. Liberating to cite something and be your own.

How I know about it – more my family experience not personal experience, didnt feel comfortable going into detail about something I didnt know as well. Part of who I am and how i grew up but didnt feel comfortable sharing details.

How did this affect how you felt about your work on your paper?

It felt really weird at first because you're not supposed to do that. It was satisfying to be able to use that. Not just “oh you made that up.” valid in using it.

How did (?) this affect how and why you wrote your paper?

No – if i didnt have that option, I would have gone and looked for another source – a good example that I understood well. Easier and nice to use my own rather than have someone else validate it.

Did you research differently?

I still wanted to keep my research as much as possible by using academic sources, and original people's experience, and outside sources, it helped balance things out by being purely academic versus purely bibliography (own experience). I read a book about a guy who was there who lived it. Way to bring the two together.

How to make better?

It felt a little weird ethically to cite something that I had no way to backup – since high school and middle school, you are taught to always have a source for something. I feel like I have to be really careful – it could be something very easily abused – Why I chose to not use too much.

Did you think about doing interviews with family members? No – Sensitive subject. If you can't interview, because people have passed away or sensitive. Events – intergenerational impact, not just the generation who directly experienced it, but generations after. Physical impact research [family experience can be good way to represent if people passed away or you can't do interviews]

Suggestions: addressing ethical dilemma (too strong) recognizing fine line between legitimate personal experience and pushing the envelope

I'm a big believer in citations, and backing it up, it was difficult. Just knowing how much we can push and where to stop. Chose to be more conservative, concern about pushing too far.

At this point people are here because they care and they understand – we need a good foundation for it, it could be really productive.

Student #3**Why did you choose to do the interview? (had you already done it or did you do it for the paper?)**

Had done the interview for a previous class, revisited the relationship, in put on paper. Original assignment for immigration class, interview someone and write report. Wanted to use it in this paper, doing that first interview really sparked interest, done a few things related, wanted to incorporate it again. Picked paper topic based on interest sparked by interview.

How did this affect how you felt about your work on your paper?

Made it more personal, made me more interested in the subject matter because I knew someone who it was directly affecting.

How know – dad worked with him, coworker, Dad had told me stories of this person. I was talking my project, then you have to – larger network of community.

[maintain relationship over time] – He was a leader in co-ethnic community in seattle community – he put me into contact with larger seattle community, introduced to whole other world with one project.

How did (?) this affect how and why you wrote your paper?

It made me feel like i needed to be more careful, didn't want to misrepresent the person and the situation. Because i decided my paper topic on this previous interview. Wrote my paper around his input, based it off on his opinion and viewpoints – using interview as foundation for paper and developing arguments out of it.

Did you research differently?

No – only maybe driven by interview, as opposed by a research question. Topic or a region – broadly all kinds of things about that topic and region, see how project question fits in with the research I do.

Family: Don't have interesting story – lots of travel interested in history and culture – interact with lots of culture and people from different places, I could integrate experience or interactions. In order to make research more full.

Internship class for LSJ we had to write issue topic paper about our internship, I picked writing about domestic violence advocate. People who I worked with. Cited the same way – not something they said explicitly, but cited in the same way.

Suggestions/improvements:

Required thing for another class. – some problems of accessibility – more guidance, provide people.

It made the project more personal, more interested, taking the original class – really sparked my interest, developing relationships with other people. Opened me up.

If not able to use? – I wouldn't have selected South Sudan as the topic. But would have found a way to make it personal.

Student #4

Why did you choose to do the interview? (had you already done it or did you do it for the paper?)

At some point I could write about the Kurdish, excited to have the opportunity to do interview. Grew up with Kurdish friends from where I grew up.

Academia likes to take responsibility – deconstruct colonial inequalities, historically done a big part of upholding it – diminish people who experienced it – doesn't value the voices of people who lived it, puts more value

Interviews by western authors, studied extensively – got most fruitful and well-round opinions from the people who lived it, versus

First hand experience most biased = least biased – turkey is a group a variety of different peoples, complex and nuanced problems – why Turkish government would have done these things

Dismissing country as nationalist, Orientalizing “they are just backwards”, flattened this whole huge country – really is much more nuanced and historical. genocide, Armenian genocide. Far enough removed – 40 years ago, degree from country halfway around the world. If scholars are serious about breaking down colonial barriers, include, uplift, and trust the voices of people who have experienced this first hand.

Had a hard time writing this until I had a second more in-depth interview

How did this affect how you felt about your work on your paper?

I felt like it made my paper stronger, it pushed me past the point of being far removed, got me closer to the subject.

How did (?) this affect how and why you wrote your paper?

Would have been less interested. Not as strong. He did say something crazy, not sure if take it as a fact. International business collude with Turkish government – profit off of this conflict. Everyone else is suffering, actual Turkish government is suffering. Outsourcing labor, drives down dollar – I couldn't find that anywhere online.

Looked for other Kurdish authors – kurdishproject.org, found similar things – scholarly articles from Kurdish Turkish articles, people are still being marginalized, not access to higher education, can't share their voices.

This one woman took the oath for parliament, added sentence in Kurdish, and almost put her in jail. Esteemed politicians cant actively engage in culture – why can't find good scholarly articles, why didn't find academic articles because people are afraid to write about it.

Pretty sure he was saying what was true, hard to corroborate, could have done more interviews. How do you credit it? What is credible.

In college assigned a topic – grown up with family friends, having conversations, ever since high school – started to get a more academic view – helped choose what kinds of questions to ask. Build on existing community relationships.

Did you research differently?

Would have talked more about nationalism and more about the historical implications falling of ottoman empire. After interview more modern, global economy. Shifted how wrote paper.

Learned a lot of interesting things how conflict with ISIS is affecting Turkey problem. ISIS only cohesive group in the ISIS area were Kurds – US general admiring Kurds in fighting ISIS, were able to collect as an adhesive group across this region. Turkey then bombed Kurds – cared more about Kurds gaining support instead of ISIS.

Would have only done Turkish nationalism.

Good using grassroots website, leader of PKK, writing from prison for 50 years, head of the movement.

I could write 10 more papers – there is so much! International relations, global economy. Undergraduate research symposium ?? could keep using this topic in future papers.

If not able to use? What would you have done?

Own personal or family experience? What would that be like?

I would write about my family or community. What should write recommendation about for study abroad – women’s rights, eastern Europe – can relate more to that regional area. Think about how I want to bring this into my career, see if I want to live abroad, international legal education. All of college, human rights issues.

Suggestions/improvements:

Problem – imposter syndrome – how to do it. Never done before nervous. Favorite examples of good interviews. Documentaries, read essays with personal interviews, how to incorporate into paper – how someone wrote it into the paper. Writing examples – more from college people.

Student #6

Why did you not cite your personal experience/interviews for this paper?

I felt like after researching a lot and knowing a lot more about the entirety of South Africa in the Western Cape was not legitimate enough, not feel confident. Even the time I spent there, it was immersive but I didn’t travel outside.

Didn’t want to make sweeping generalizations,

Specific conversations? Spent time in prisons and communities – very impactful – would have wanted when data is coming up about townships – doesn’t represent what is going on in townships.

Conversations that I had were so specific, would be hard to weave in – had a problem being a white woman going in the places, didn’t have peoples’ words in my mind – way i was treated was different.

Own experience? – one thing now I’m thinking about – one on one with strangers – they were acting a different way around me, even strangers from with a different country.

People I was friends with – could actually explain how people would view you. Some way could give experience.

Don’t want to make this about me – or misrepresent people’s ideas.

Different in upcoming visit to prepare for future papers?

Makes me hesitant, here is “truth” report back – South Africa was a land of complete contrasts, 5 min drive and experience totally different land, – so many different worlds in this tiny place, I would like to go and notice, more geographically aware. More observant, would be more confident of visual contrasts, further travels, geographical lines, racial segregation, know where I am better observe.

Now that I have pretty substantial relationships, solidify relationships, deeper, more comfortable around me, more honest. Cool to have this more of a foundation – I know these people. Talking in prisons. Importance of building relationships.

How to address own authority – more examples of possible ways that experience could be cited – initially thought one-on-one, at events, in rooms, uncomfortable, making it about me – other ways examples, alternative observations. And that people want to hear – where people from that country could read it – glad that the person said this, as opposed to people being like – what’s this person making a commentary about this land.

I genuinely – with it could be a 30 page paper – so much research so much knowledge and so much to say – to best represent I wanted it to be all encompassing – I would feel more comfortable adding own personal experience – ton of scholarly research, court cases, after doing all of that, then weave in interview and personal experience.

Place them pretty well in the paper – would have to make sense with whatever scholarly pieces either supplement academic or counter it.

Frustrations I had – searching very specific places – if this was happening in the US, there would be an activist pursuing this area and bringing attention – still there is a clear division of people, not a lot of mixing. Researching prisons -largest cases attention is given to crazy white people, but white people make up 3% of the prison – 6 murders, nothing to sensationalize 10 murders, not newsworthy.

Lack of access to information of alternative narratives because of ongoing systemic oppression.

Never wanted to research before, but this quarter was the first time – there isn’t enough – wrote three papers.

Suggestions/Improvements:

Examples, on how to give your information but be able to frame things in a way that is most sensitive, as a white person from US, I would always refrain from saying “in my experience” – my experience is not worth talking about over someone’s experience who lived it – if I did have something, what it looks like adding into a paper, wording it – let the reader know, I had this experience, also, it is different.

I think this is really cool, for people who have come from historically oppressed or disenfranchised, reclaim knowledge production, ability that maybe haven’t always been the leading voice, in own people’s history or history in general, for them to be able to talk about their experience and validated in a really legitimate way, really cool for production of knowledge. Changing power dynamics.

Student #10

Did you know you could cite personal interviews for your paper?

FaceTime we used in class call – check – yes – didn’t think – was using documentaries, you hear people’s personal stories, I’m not interviewing, rather than personal interviews. Access to resources, reaching out to people, I didn’t think of reaching out. Besides the class, the only time you are encouraged to use personal experience is in a personal reflection paper. Discouraged from using it, depends on course and what professor requires. General experience – writing papers within argumentative and research – you say “I” – factual evidence (personal experience) versus personal opinion – if you are using your own personal experience it can be factual, can be impacted own opinion/perspective. How i am interpreting it – can make that fact. Depends in academia, if we lose sight of personal stories because you want things that are factual based – you are weary of what you are using – good sources of evidence – personal stories are so powerful, I’ve never thought i should interview a person. What makes the guidelines important, never had someone cite personal interviews and experience – it depends who you’re writing to. Makes a paper much more powerful. More passionate.

Context of perspective. Important to ground

Access to documentaries are much easier, lack of efforts.

Apartheid – been to South Africa – effects if you have directly have a personal understanding. I’ve been there. Spoken about after effects – how the public feels about the effects of apartheid. Talked to a lot of people.

With family – topic – my grandparents – fought in WW2 – their experience, a subject – happening in the US. generational perspective from a bystander who doesn’t have background information, if you could interview different generations. Are all they all seeing it the same way or differently.

Why did you not cite your personal experience/interviews for this paper?

Can you imagine a situation in which you would cite your personal experience/interviews? What would it look like?

Is there a way to make you more likely to do it?

If you had the opportunity again in the future would you consider doing it?

Do you have any suggestions for improvements to the guidelines?

Acceptable versus not acceptable – where knowledge production is coming from – giving context

How you can do it, what makes it not acceptable – clarify what this is more – could be deterred if not clear. This is not acceptable (include why it’s not) even with just one. What to know why each one is not acceptable to be more clear.

Lots of examples are good.

Student #5

Why did you choose to do the interview? (had you already done it or did you do it for the paper?)

Conversation, not as much an interview. Interview did – with roommate, a year and a half – told life experiences, really interested. Would just tell anecdotes, roommate knew about paper, roommate offered, thought it was cool chose paper topic. Had some questions, asked roommate for permission, became into conversation.

What made you pick paper topic?

Personally have taken classes in HR, didnt know much of what was going on in middle east, why, why had never heard about it, wanted to learn academically. Easier for me personally to understand, we just read harvard articles, scholarship so impersonal. Saw

that i had a personal connection. In media, hear about seria and yemen, dont hear about region.

When asked to use scholarly sources, asked to focus on is the abstract, the author's thesis, they are trying to answer some question about some particular topic. When i was thinking about researching looking at articles in library databases, why are we focusing on one specific argument when there are so many other factors going on in the situation. When focus on question or answer, hard to find useful information. A lot of classes, forced to sift through all these questions and theories, very specific to authors own field of study – difficult for me, didn't really find academic articles useful, not focused on broader context including personal experiences.

Really stuck with me admittance of testimonies in court, personal experiences typically taken with a grain of salt, instead of “expert witness” – great some of the time, but a dynamic of expert testimony taken much more heavily, more significance from people who

Why reading all of these articles while someone is personally willing to talk about these experiences, more qualified.

Another problem doing scholarly articles, they weren't focused on specific group – tried to lump Yazidis compared with Syria, not individual experiences of people who had faced that type of oppression. Different political interests, layers, – but roommate just talked about her experience, wasn't aware of different groups, we needed to get out.

Scholarly articles too analytical, more impersonal. Missing human impact. It is exclusive, articles had never done interviews with people. Had zero connection with people, never travelled.

How did this affect how you felt about your work on your paper?

By using the guidelines made me feel compelled to do a better job. It made me feel bad reading about it, after i finished interview, who am i to write about this – own positionality. Made me feel weird to write about someone else's experiences. If i had never done the interview, i would have taken political analytical take. After interview, made me feel a little lost, what am I actually write about. If i wasn't able to use interview, i wouldn't have had a deeper understanding. I wouldn't have sought out for other sources.

Gave you an opportunity to push yourself – crazy after paper – reflected back on other papers, wait a second, why did i never seek out a interview source before. Annoyed at self, why did other professors not consider this? If included a personal account, would not have been accepted, would have asked for an academic source. Made me feel bad. What other papers could I have use this sources.

I never thought I would think about this – it is hard to talk about in class. We talked a lot in class about debriefing struggling with understanding why you are doing human rights work, why studying. Personal interviews, gave the option. One hard for me to deal with personally, but a better understanding of what is happening in the world. Not just purely academic sterile stuff.

How did (?) this affect how and why you wrote your paper?

Own history/community/family?

Just applied to LSJ major, used in my application, a personal experience. Worried about admissions committee, they are going to think I'm being dramatic. But i used personal experience to classwork. Thought about applying in the fall, looking back at old draft, I didn't use personal experience in fall application. I felt more comfortable, generally, comfortable in personal experiences in formal academic settings. Subconsciously a thing, in applications now, more able to cite personal experience, i know about this because x, y, z.

You have something of value to add. Yes I do have authority to speak on this. Personal experience to talk about other things. Who is to say this isn't valid. Scared, if I use this does it invalidate other personal experiences.

Gets you to think about your own position. Does have validity, plays into education.

Evaluated on GPA, but what we learn purely in course. If you have something that has changed your life and you learned a lot, don't think this can be dismissed. Education beyond GPA. Decolonizing, respecting different forms of information.

Suggestions to improve:

Unsure how much to cite. Academic sources you're supposed to paraphrase or use direct quotations. Not sure how to write this in a paper. How to incorporate direct quotes – examples. Even people we skyped in classes. Giving examples. How literally write that out. We're not used to writing about personal experiences. Actual writing part. Especially citing, like with last names, how to incorporate interviews. Awkward to write. Formal vs informal citing personal interview.

Really excited because the conversation we had in class, in courtrooms, how different people's voices are respected, the formal place of a classroom – dialogue of people's experiences.

Student #7**Did you know you could cite personal interviews for your paper?**

No – didn't occur to me but when introduced. Didn't occur to me because it is ingrained in my writing not supposed to use I statements, because it detracts from your argument. First person talk takes away from what you are trying to argue. If i used my own experience would detract from my argument, or not be considered as credible. Academic writing. Feels unnatural. Haven't done in other classes. Or flat out written to talk about your experience. Never for a research paper.

Why did you not cite your personal experience/interviews for this paper?

It was a topic i felt invested in because I had been reading in the news. The severity of the situation that I felt i could add to my argument. Not being Filipina, doesn't touch on people and community you know. Personal experiences in class – felt like I couldn't add. Too disconnected. No neighbors or friends.

Even if I did have something I could connect to, something Seattle based, would be hard to want to include personal experience. Emotional that makes it hard to = easier that I care about, instead of super connected, it would be hard for me to write objective. Sometimes you do want a bit of distance.

For me personally, I would have a hard time interviewing people. Even though that's not = I also don't really have anything in my life that I could brought into life. Something that people could bring it in personally – there are few avenues where you can use experience to educate people, allowing students to use personal experiences as an opportunity that can rationalize circumstances, way of coping, processing further understanding your own life.

Can you imagine a situation in which you would cite your personal experience/interviews? What would it look like?

My mom is the one in my family who is the breadwinner – my dad has been the stay at home dad, cooks etc. could see myself talk about this.

Mental health – being in Seattle experiences – people otherwise not having the outlet – talk about it in an analytical academic way. Interesting outlooks. Full time student. Entering the real world. Value in having an actual experience. More credibility sharing story, connects to narrative of who someone is. When you are trying to make a point. This helped shape my way of viewing the world. Making the point more clear because it is my experience. Own positionality to what you're writing about.

Is there a way to make you more likely to do it?

Would you have changed paper topic – may have changed, but it's hard to say. Would have done research to see what I could relate to. Sister was in peace corps in Tonga. Had been reading a lot

If you had the opportunity again in the future would you consider doing it?**Do you have any suggestions for improvements to the guidelines?**

Intimidation – going back to the beginning of the conversation – knowing how its not common place for me as a writer to bring in personal experiences, to know its an option, uncharted territory, incorporating into other readings, show examples, make a point of showing examples of how a person brought in personal experience. Some books, media and articles, but more explicit connection of how you can do this effectively.

From the get-go, that we can do at the beginning

Struggling with how we are taught to write. If you have something that will benefit your writing that will support your argument.

Start earlier from earlier education

Especially when not comfortable, need a template. Hard because you need to know what to share what not to share. How to connect, cohesive – could be intimidating – how to actually structure it in a way that's effective.

Student #9**Did you know you could cite personal interviews for your paper?**

Irma Alicia – what motivated to use in paper – find another source to support the point I was trying to make. A person who has gone through a direct experience of loss of justice and their own path, it was validating more so than a secondary.

In secondary sources, we put pressure to be void without feelings because we don't to have bias, but then when you are talking about such as a human rights violation and genocide, how cannot have feelings and not incorporate individual emotions. The paper

becomes more biased, it loses a quality that doesn't seem right.

How did this affect how you felt about your work on your paper?

I was trying to find a good source of evidence – it goes back to who gets to tell the story. I am the one with the pen and the paper, how do represent the marginalized voices and population. Makes you more conscious and aware of your contribution but also the experience people have gone through are real, strips all vulnerability and don't see human element.

In order for human rights, in order for people to recognize its important, you have to make it relevant, and meaningful, or otherwise its just another UN treaty that people wouldn't bother to research or make critical evaluations.

Why did you not cite your personal experience/interviews for this paper?

Don't know anyone, if I did would be about Thai people perspective. Didn't know where to reach out.

Can you imagine a situation in which you would cite your personal experience/interviews? What would it look like?

Why not do research topic in Thailand. – war on drugs relevant to me at that time, other paper the year before on war on drugs, have conversation with family. This was way of saying what I think.

News watch and conversations you are having.

It would depend on the topic, if I felt I had something to say. I would be more weary about putting myself in than other people. When we write formal and critical papers, it is taboo to write about ourselves. I would try to incorporate more personal voices. More comfortable with neighbors, other people's voices.

Is there a way to make you more likely to do it?

If you had the opportunity again in the future would you consider doing it?

Do you have any suggestions for improvements to the guidelines?

Everything was very straightforward and clear

Is it important, it is so lost, something we are not taught at all. We don't know how. When you are not encouraged to do so, not told the option, you are not given guidelines, it is deterring.

You have to be careful. When it is a mix of secondary and primary. Doesn't detract from credibility. Important that you are just as critical when choosing the primary sources, looking at the motivations behind the arguments, what institution is representing. Even if a personal experience, you should be weary of same thing. Deep context.

Student #8

Did you know you could cite interviews in your paper?

yes

Why did you not cite your personal experience/interviews for this paper?

Topic I was writing about did not have personal experience, a country that was in Africa, I've never been there, or the continent, didn't come from a place of having personal knowledge. Was going off of testimony that people had formed, didn't know anyone in immediate surroundings, may have been but none that i knew of.

Also when it comes to interviews, i am going to be conducting a lot of interviews, comfortable with the idea, school system, i came from a high school that was very into writing, all types of formats and properly cite the sources. The opportunity to talk to people about personal experiences was never really an option. We were never assigned something that made us something that made us use those personal connections. Even though i knew i could have, it was a foreign concept because I've never done it.

If you had known someone would you have done an interview.

I want to say yes, but I would probably have not done it. If there is a power-play when it comes to interview. You asking someone for their time, you have this power, but I am someone who depending on the situation, if i am in a place of power, I will ask. When it comes to school assignments, who am i to conduct this interview, answer this questions, take time out of their day, when they are doing me a favor. If a neighbor, someone who was a friend or an acquaintance – but during the time doing the paper, I would have reached out and I didn't have the personal connection feeling comfortable enough to ask, and not in a position of an authority.

In terms of this interview you're my professor – terms of power. Not a huge deal. Or not my professor. Could have been different. Had I not known you, not feel comfortable.

Example of this interview, since you were professor, you have a position of authority, professor/student. If it had happened during class time, either way wouldn't have been an issue. If i was conducting an interview and I did not have power, less incentive of the person on the other side for not wanting to do the interview. Student versus student – someone who holds power, professor, legislator, i would feel at their will beck and call, would make me opposed the interview. Even though i am conducting, i feel i am below them, i am a "nuisance." I dont have the right to conduct, i don't have power over them. Not legitimate request because of the power differential, a low priority. Or ask about someone's personal experience and then using them. Don't have the power to leverage not worth my time, don't want to impose your power, not obligated, other side of the spectrum, you have no power so you don't want to even ask.

Personal relationships are key – if interviews were more accepted, that could potentially helped. If they were more common in the education system, if it was common practice, maybe we as a society would feel and understand. It is common. This makes sense as to why you would want to interview.

Personal experiences aren't always seen as valid as they should be not seen as reliable sources in current societies – catches you off guard, why asking for an interview. Is it worth your time or my time – common practice more acceptable, oh yes, makes sense why you would want to interview me. Worth time and energy.

Research is not based on people, based on scientific reasoning when its face to face contact, so used to getting information from scholarly source, all the stories started with a person. No ones used to. Culture of what is valid knowledge.

Not know how to go about, and not having anyone to interview.

Can you imagine a situation in which you would cite your personal experience/interviews? What would it look like?

Yes – as I briefly glanced over – I have to write a paper for the internship about legislation – I didn't have to choose a topic of interviewing.

I can see using my experience and those of other peoples. I have to do it, but i want to because will add a depth to the assignment, will give it a more personal touch. If i were to write a paper on topics that is impersonal it is attached, it is important to.

Is there a way to make you more likely to do it?

If you had the opportunity again in the future would you consider doing it?

Do you have any suggestions for improvements to the guidelines?

Our class did a good job, others might now – you came in with the idea of other people's experiences main graded aspect, paper was assigned well in advance, if we were able to choose a topic and take into account our personal experiences, and who we might be able to interview, who use as an academic source, similar assignments, dive deep and get passionate, encompasses it full, and then spring it on you and then you have two weeks.

Would be difficult to get a source to interview. Putting a time restraint would be difficult. They are doing you a favor by doing an interview, and they cant do it for three weeks, you have to turn in the paper missing a really good experience. Interviews highly sought after, professors love when you can get interviews, but they don't assist you in the process. They don't tell you how to do conduct an interview, or how to give one, or give you time to do so. No one can utilize.

Knowledge production – talked a lot in class how research starts as a story, all articles books scholarly sources and peer reviewed articles started out as a story somehow, how they are often viewed in a better light than personal experiences because we value what is on paper than what is currently happening or has happened in someone's life. A teacher might say it doesn't count as a scholarly source. What we find a lot in universities, we started moving out of using any source, into you have to have 10 source, 7 of them must be be peer reviewed. Odd because there is this gap in people's minds that an article stems from someone personal experience, but it's different. How personal experiences don't count

Creating this power dynamic where students feel like they can't use certain research because its not valid and it deters them from utilizing other forms of research when a university doesn't really allow it. Weird because universities will train you to write a certain way that is very impersonal, and detached from reality because it is so based in writing we aren't taking into account personal aspect. All this big idea that is hard to pinpoint.

Presenting with me – whose project is it? – shared experience – people be part of the project, a very interesting aspect – more personal experience.

See how people at the universities react to it. I do wonder if teachers/professors would think that verbal testimony is that important. Someone lied during an interview. Or student potentially taking advantage, making up an interview, was midnight and had to turn something in. students would be interested. What people think at national level, certain kind of writing is correct. We write a paper because it's not how someone else would have written it or gone about researching it, not fair, it is devaluing work we put into it. Asking people how you think about – we don't think about it, how certain information is prioritized more than others, do studies more on the national studies at the national level, personal experiences in writing and research- acceptability, not peer reviewed if not valid, harming how we see things, there is so much emphasis on checking your sources that is correct, the point that we have lost connection to making sure that what we include, not the whole story. It is off putting from a very statistical point of view, not personal – all research has to be detached, and more important than research that is deeply involved.

Scary and important, takes a lot more work to do an interview, and to tell you story or have someone tell their story.

Prioritizing hierarchy – Harvard, vs local community college – who put more effort into their study, Harvard study was more legitimate, the name of the university, the aspect and prioritize –

This page titled [3.2: Notes from Interviews with Students \(2018\)](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard](#), [Emma Macdonald-Scott](#), and [Jake Lally](#).

3.3: Notes from Interviews with Students (2019) 3.3: Notes from Interviews with Students (2019)Edit Update titlecancel

15

Notes from Interviews with Students (2019)

Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally

The following are notes taken when Emily interviewed students following the second use of the citations guidelines. They were used in the course “Human Rights in Latin America” taught in Summer Quarter of 2019. The course was designed by Dr. Angelina Godoy, and adapted by Emily for this Summer Quarter. While the “International Justice on Trial” had a single large research paper, this course had three smaller assignments.

The interviews were conducted via telephone in the summer of 2019 after the end of the quarter and after grades had been turned in and distributed to students. Emily obtained informed consent from all of the participants for her to take notes and use the information shared in this ongoing project to improve the guidelines. Emily also obtained consent to anonymously use excerpts of the students’ papers in future publications or presentations. The notes have been anonymized to protect student privacy. These notes include both questions asked and responses.

Summary:

Spoke to 3 students. Student #1 used the guidelines, students #2 and #3 did not use it.

Interview with (student #1) – HRLA Summer 2019

Could you remind me of how and for what assignments you used it?

Last one, and second one. Roommate was going to the store we were speaking Spanish and getting looks at Target. Flight or fight – do you want to argue. If someone did say something, would have said something back. Evidence for argument or counter argument. Other – person from Yakima, valid point of view. Where she lives next to a big lot where people park RVs, where ICE was with trucks and uniforms, could see from her doorway.

Why did you choose to do the interview/personal experience? (had you already done it or did you do it for the paper?)

Strengthen the argument – to give a real-life perspective. Not happening anonymously, we can read about something happening in Europe but if there is no real live examples. I am going to take it as the news, but I won’t have the connection – empathy and sympathy to give more attention. Pathos aspect – emotional aspect of argument. Give some humanity.

How did this affect how you felt about your work on your paper?

It felt better because I had more substance to the paper. Humanity to it. Helped make connections between what I was reading and real life – connect different aspects that wasn’t straight up saying. Come up with your ideas.

How did (?) this affect how and why you wrote your paper?

The articles for Yakima said ICE was using Yakima resources – are your parents paying taxes? Undocumented – the people are paying for your own deportation. Made own connections and confirmed them. She was my roommate – as I was doing the research, if I had questions I asked her – what do you think of it. Do you have any connections. If something comes up you could ask her. Had talked about it before – yes. Related to similar backgrounds. Small populations – we stuck together. Ironies in the news. On going relationship.

Do you have any suggestions for improvements to the guidelines?

Yes they were helpful – examples. Second assignment – said give it credibility even if it was anonymous – put who and where she is mini description. Examples were helpful, knew how to cite it. Adding the section about anonymous – what to do?

Have you used something similar to this before in other classes?

NO haven’t – first time given me

Would you like the opportunity to use this in other classes?

Yes because I am taking a class right now and international human rights and I want to do a paper on Guatemala.

Final reflections:

Seems straight forward – APA citations and MLA – how to use about anonymous. Good having different citation styles. Examples were helpful.

Interview with (student #2) – HRLA Summer 2019**Could you remind me of how and for what assignments you used it?**

No, you didn't use it – no time I needed to use it. – research paper was more closely related to my own experience conversations and work that you do. Didn't get to choose the paper/assignment topics. Class assignments were more about stuff wasn't as familiar.

How did this affect how you felt about your work on your paper?

For research paper – more closely related more passionate because more personally invested. I cared about this past summer, but I was using other peoples' information to form my opinion. In the other paper it was more my own experience and personal input which made me feel more closely tied to it.

Interviews?

Didn't think about it – wouldn't know who to interview. If someone was close to in my life. Wasn't worth the extra effort to go find someone to interview.

Do you have any suggestions for improvements to the guidelines?

Citing the timeline – lived experience of my life – I wouldn't know how to cite life-time – course of own life-time experience. How to say it more concisely. Wrote a long explanation for intext.

More personal details about personal life experience. In footnotes, or if optional don't use them, don't know. In-text citation – an annotation in the bibliography explaining life experience. Help to add prior context. Between these years estimate. General timeline – racial biases – labeling people. Context of life experiences.

Have you used something similar to this before in other classes?

When abroad – we didn't cite it. In reflective papers we didn't have to cite it – make a note – no citation because an opinion. If I say anything – professors just assume its your own take – personal experience.

Interviews no.

Would you like the opportunity to use this in other classes?

It is helpful – you have to cite everything you say, but I don't have a textbook and page number, it's my lived experience, and then you have to leave it.

Final reflections:

I liked it nice to be able to use it. It makes anything you write more personal. A lot of times you are asked to pick a topic that you feel passionate about, but cant put in your own knowledge.

Interview with (student #3) – HRLA Summer 2019**Could you remind me of how and for what assignments you used it?**

Did not use

Why did you not use?

Didn't have personal experience in this HRLA class – but for other classes – ask grandpa about Korean war, mom encourages. Never been a way to implement in a real way. Have thought about before but hasn't been a mechanism. Grandpa growing up in the great depression, Dad grew up in Sweden – parents and grandparents experiences inside and outside the US = have been able to mentally connect information, but not directly use it in class. No chance to analyze, further research, or more deeply engage.

Own experiences?

Availability would be really important. Being able to use current experiences or an internship. Volunteering at the municipal court – so much I see – relates to so many different topics, would be interesting to have the possibility to actually engage that in a formal/academic setting.

Would this affect how you felt about your work on your paper?

Not only add unique component to a paper – I think that would enhance the process to make it easier to get excited about it – talk to someone that had specific experience. Make paper more interesting and engaging. Fun and unique in a different way – instead of googling academic journals.

Its unique, its not some super academic scholar, a unique perspective, more people could relate with.

Do you have any suggestions for improvements to the guidelines?

Haven't looked at them closely.

Have you used something similar to this before in other classes?

No other classes – Poli Sci and LSJ

She brought it up – publish a paper she liked the idea, really useful.

Would you like the opportunity to use this in other classes?**Final Reflections**

This page titled [3.3: Notes from Interviews with Students \(2019\)](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard](#), [Emma Macdonald-Scott](#), and [Jake Lally](#).

3.4: Notes from Interview with Graduate Student (2020) 3.4: Notes from Interview with Graduate Student (2020)Edit Update titlecancel

16

Notes from Interview with Graduate Student (2020)

Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally

Emily shared the guidelines with a friend who shared them with her classmates for use in a group project, with the professor's permission. Emily conducted an interview via Zoom in 2020 about the student's use of the guidelines. Emily obtained informed consent from the student for her to take notes and use the information shared in this ongoing project to improve the guidelines. Emily also obtained consent to anonymously use excerpts of the student's paper in future publications or presentations. The notes have been anonymized to protect student privacy. These notes include both questions asked and responses.

Conversation with Student – MSW Program at UW

Interview conducted by Emily via Zoom on 10/23/2020

Did you use the citation guidelines?

What was the assignment/project?

How did you use them (interview or personal experience)?

How did the guidelines work for you?

Do you think using them affect how you approached the assignment?

Do you have feedback/thoughts about them?

Do you have suggestions about how to make them better?

Indigenous student used personal experience/interview with friend in group paper assignment about suicide among Indigenous youth.

Used personal experience

Provided background and historical context, historical context.

Provide more depth to what I said, allows connection to research

-looking at research around the topic, in the media and suicide rates, what i had to say was not represented

providing native people justice doesn't happen, its a public health crisis and is ignored by officials so there wouldn't be much "official" information anyway. why personal experience is important "there are no amber alerts for us" children too

being native is – the US goal is to wipe us out, genocide is still ongoing

rates of COVID were highest on reservations – no tests PPE

lots of violence is done by white men from the outside, they can't be tracked and operate anonymously

genocide and suicide- mental health is a huge issues – some places have resources, other help, are more accessible. white middle class areas or institutions that serve, lacking in native community – ignored pushed aside, prioritize other people

media and suicide – Pocahontas native characters in movies are incorrect most of the time. perpetuates ideas of "savages" is given to kids. they grow up with that idea of themselves, they are not worthy, not deserving – anyone can just take up their identity in native costumes, like blonde with headdress, erases and dehumanizes. erases the kids_____

improvements on the guidelines – yes useful. professors response was that they thought it was cool. the grad students thought it was a cool way to cite.

this is important in grad work "I could write about stuff I relate to"

"if it's not something I'm in, I get bored, its how I relate"

"one of the best tools to use, another level of depth to the paper that couldn't be produced another way"

"In my paper I quote a friend. if we can quote other people, we can quote ourselves."

This page titled [3.4: Notes from Interview with Graduate Student \(2020\)](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard](#), [Emma Macdonald-Scott](#), and [Jake Lally](#).

3.5: Notes from Interviews with Professors and Instructors 3.5: Notes from Interviews with Professors and Instructors

17

Notes from Interviews with Professors and Instructors

Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally

These interviews were conducted by Emma of professors and instructors, as well as a person from the Center for Teaching and Learning. Emma obtained informed consent from the participants for the following interviews.

Professor of Social Sciences

Interview Conducted by Emma in 2019

Note: This professor gives students an assignment to conduct interviews as a part of the coursework

Why do you assign Student conducted interviews?

- Master narratives and the power dynamics that shape them
- The essential role of other stories from those with “lesser” power
- To help students exercise agency/power
- The role of language (how we say it as important as what we say)
 - Also the power of everyday interactions to disrupt master narratives
 - Consider the power of “illegal” to describe undocumented immigrants: language impacts thoughts and actions

Student Response:

- Positive
 - Intimate connection
 - Personal experience can teach!
 - Improves confidence in one's own knowledge/ experience or in their abilities to make connections and create/seek new knowledge
- Negative
 - Trauma/violence can come up – space of vulnerability- delicate situations
 - Some people cannot share their stories
 - Learning something you are not prepared to and cannot unlearn- particularly with family interviews

Any Problems that have arisen?

- Provide options other than interview

Center for Teaching and Learning (July 2019)

1. Have you seen any paper(s) like ours before? Are we bringing something new to the scholarship?

1. Has not seen a project like ours and definitely sees it as a very original idea.
2. People doing related work who I have now been connected with via email.
 1. [Mike Honey](#) – works with oral histories and anti-racist pedagogy, Prof. of civil and labor rights history at UW Tacoma — May not be able to meet due to a busy schedule and some recent hardships.
 2. [Tikka Sears](#) – Director of [Theater for Change](#) which works to advance community dialogue through personal narrative sharing and performance (tackles issues like classroom hierarchies, bias, discrimination, etc.)
 3. [Elba Moise](#) – Works in the Center for Teaching and Learning with a focus on multicultural education. — Works with Tikka on Theater for Change

3. Do you know of any studies/ research that connects this type of personal engagement with student work to better success or engagement?

1. No specifics but...
2. “ It is a truism in writing that students do better when connected with their work. You have probably seen this before that in writing many instructors begin with a personal writing piece of some sort, you write about yourself, your experience, something you’re an expert in and then you go from there. And it’s not just writing, it’s an evidence based teaching strategy. I don’t know of a specific study or theory, but yes, you’re right, students do better.”

2. Do you have any recommended readings related to our topic? What about examples of similar work we could draw formatting inspiration from?

1. No recommendations for readings BUT highly recommended going to the ode writing and research center to further explore.
2. Ode writing and research currently between directors until mid August, check in then.
3. Connected me with [Olivia Kenney](#) to survey writing center tutors to see if this is a question that comes up often and how the writing center responds.

3. Do you have any suggestions for journals that our project would fit in for publishing?

1. Thinks we probably want to look for journals in the realm of scholarship of teaching as opposed to disciplinary education
OR
 1. Human rights ed
 2. Pol S ed
 3. LA studies ed
 4. Assessment scholars – education or writing
2. Find journals w general connections and then read their table of contents and see how your work fits w the other articles
3. Recommended that we come back to talk to her when we’re further along. Hone in on our:
 1. Goals
 2. audience

4. Do you have any recommended readings for creating a curriculum/ adaptable framework around this project?

1. Course design not curriculum – outline + implementation
2. [Katie Malcom](#) – met with Katie briefly after my meeting with Beth. She recommended and send me the PDF version of a book ([Aligning for Learning – Wulff et. al](#)) about course design that might fit our project and the broad applicability we’re looking for.

Professor of Social Sciences (June 2019)

Why did you choose to integrate student produced knowledge into your class?

- Teaching with the goal of changing the way that people think and changing the way people feel, the latter being a more difficult challenge
 - Especially important in the study of immigration because we tend to speak about the human beings who migrate in disconnected ways which discount their humanity
 - But more generally in social sciences researchers/students are often disconnected from their subjects
 - This can also mean you miss some things in research

What has the student response been like?

- Used to have a rule about not letting students interview family because of a desire to take students beyond their existing ideas/networks
 - For the student and the subject – make new connections/ expand thought
 - Changed policy because it allowed students to connect to their family stories
 - Overwhelmingly positive responses
 - Addressing family secrets – many students knew little about migration stories of their family, sometimes tied to shame or negative experiences in home country
 - Connecting people with where their families are from

- Hearing stories they may have never otherwise heard → starting a dialogue which can last
 - Trinh Mai – connecting through photographs
 - Gaining the ability to understand each other through stories – especially with older generations

Have you run into any problems with its use?

- None because interviews were never required, always given the option
 - Alternatives:
 - Service learning + a short response essay – still getting people to connect with others – changing feelings and thoughts
 - Writing fiction story – making up characters so that you're still obligated to empathize and understand people as complex beings.
- Initially it was difficult for people to find someone to interview but times have changed, social media makes connections easier +
- Credibility not an issue – always requires further support
 - A piece of evidence not the entirety of the project

Do you have any recommendations for our project in terms of curriculum development?

- Speak with Beth Kalikoff
- Trinh Mai – integrating Art
 - If you want people to connect with their subjects give them something to engage with. – conveying individual experience and sometimes collective experience

Recommended Reading:

Friedman, Kathie, and Karen Rosenberg. "Performing Identities in the Classroom: Teaching Jewish Women's Studies." *Teaching Sociology* 35, no. 4 (2007): 315-33.

- Written by Prof. Friedman with a grad student who was taking this class on Jewish women's studies with mostly undergrads.
- Classroom dynamic was so weird and problematic → grad student wanted to drop course → turn it into a research project, take extensive notes on what it is that makes the dynamic weird
- Main conclusions:
 - In classes analyzing identities and intersectionality the relationship between theory and experience must constantly be interrogated by students and instructors
 - "Women's studies students frequently mention what they remember most from a course in terms of importance in their lives is not any particular reading, but the analytical tools they learn to apply to their own lives"
 - focus on the importance of:
 - Sharing authority in the classroom
 - Power and importance of personal experience in the classroom
 - BUT also must be challenged and problematized

This page titled [3.5: Notes from Interviews with Professors and Instructors](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally](#).

3.6: 2019 Praxis Presentation 3.6: 2019 Praxis PresentationEdit Update titlecancel

18

2019 Praxis Presentation

Emily Willard, Emma Macdonald-Scott, and Jake Lally

In February 2019, Emily presented the project at the University of Washington Department of English Praxis conference titled [“Anti-Racist Pedagogy: Visions and Practices for Institutional Change.”](#)

At the conference, Emily presented the guidelines and provided examples of how students used it in the classroom.

See the PDF version of the presentation slides here: [Students Produce Knowledge Presentation Slides](#)

See the PDF version of the presentation outline and notes here: [Praxis 2019 – Presentation Outline 2-21-19](#)

See a full text copy of the presentation outline and notes below.

Introduce Self – Emily Willard, she/her pronouns – PhD Candidate in JSIS, also a graduate fellow in the CLASS – Comparative Law & Societies. I was an instructor for the LSJ department, and am a TA in JSIS & LSJ.

What I’m presenting – In LSJ seminar class last fall, I developed Guidelines for students to cite their personal experiences and interviews as evidence in their final research papers. The main idea is to challenge traditional concepts of who is allowed to produce knowledge, whose knowledge gets valued, and why it is valued. I made copies of the guidelines. You can take them with you, but please don’t publish, copy, or circulate before we get a chance to talk about it more. It would be great if we could get more people to be using them, but it would be nice for me to know if you are interested. Acknowledge students in the room who used them, and participated in this work. After talking with them I realize that to take this a step further in challenging traditional ideas about knowledge production and putting it into practice, that we are now beginning to make this a shared project. IF SO – some of the students are here IF SO – they are happy to answer any questions during Q and A. We are in the process of discussing what a more shared project between us would look like. Happy to discuss and work on this more.

OUTLINE OF TALK: First will share my goals for this presentation, explain how my creation of these guidelines came about, and then the results of putting it into action, including feedback from students in my class.

[SLIDE] Say Purpose of presentation – Three Goals

1. Share what I did and what I learned
2. Get feedback on the guidelines
3. Connect with other people – imagine that many people are also working on this – would like feedback about who else is doing this kind of work to connect with them. Literature, departments, disciplines on campus.

How this came about –

- INTERNATIONAL JUSTICE ON TRIAL Describe class – International Human Rights trials, with the goal for students to critically engage the concept of justice, how it means different things to different people. Consider the ways that human rights trials do and do not achieve justice and for whom. And then think of alternative approaches to justice, beyond trials.
- As a part of the class, we had a several-week discussion about evidence that is used human rights trials, and the ideas of knowledge production. We discussed the ways in which certain knowledge is valued over other in the western court systems, particularly in the U.S., Latin America, the United Nations, and Europe. We looked at particular examples of the exclusion of fourth-person, or what U.S. courts consider “hearsay” as eyewitness testimony in trials. We discussed what kind of human rights evidence would hold up and be accepted in courts. We discussed the example of valuing of textual records over first-hand eye-witness testimony, particularly government records, for example in genocide trials.
- THEORY INTO PRACTICE – Throughout this discussion of knowledge production, it occurred to me quite hypocritical to be discussing this theoretically, without putting it into action in our class. So I created a set of guidelines for students to cite knowledge they produce as evidence for their final research paper.
- THE RESEARCH PAPER was to pick a conflict/issue area that has/is experiencing human rights violations, and determine whether or not trials could achieve “justice” however they chose to define justice. Then they had to propose alternative approaches to seeking justice that would address some of the shortcomings of the trials.

- Came back to the question, if a student was doing research on a topic they were familiar with from personal experience, family or community history, or personally knows people who have personal experience, how could I not allow them to use that as evidence in their paper? This would be going against our entire conversation of knowledge production.
- I also wanted to give them an opportunity to see that they can make a valuable contribution, and that they have something important to say.
- Practical issue when it came to grading. I was reminded of an anecdote that planned the seed of this whole idea. Several years ago there was a student in a Human Rights in Latin America class. In her midterm exam, she made several statements to support her argument about conditions in Latin America, but didn't cite her sources. She came to me in office hours and she explained that she didn't cite sources because it was her own lived experience. How could I take points off? Yet there didn't seem to be a way to guide her into doing some sort of citation so I knew she was speaking from her own knowledge. How would I have known if she didn't tell me? That is why I created these guidelines.

THE GUIDELINES –

- Contains: Introduction which describes the purpose of the guidelines, and the background discussion of knowledge production. Why this is important
- Then it contains to main sections on citing Personal Experiences and Personal Interviews
- Was important to me to include their own personal experiences, but also the experiences of their families and communities, as well as personal interviews that they conduct. A variety of ways for students to produce knowledge
- I also wanted to give them examples, and help them think through their own positionality, think about where they are coming from, and how to contextualize their voice, and the knowledge that they produce, either through personal experience or the interview. Might be the first time, so help guide students to figure out if and how to incorporate.
- The key part, I found, was also creating clear expectations/boundaries. I did this by having them give context to their citation, and focusing on using it to cite specific examples, concepts or details. Discouraging them from using the citations for more general ideas or conclusions

Based on feedback from the students, in this updated version, I have included a note about interviewing survivors of trauma and additional reading suggestions for more information.

RESULTS:

- Did survey of all of the students, questions which were included in the course evaluations, and then I did 30 min interviews with 10 students. 5 of the students did not use personal experience or interviews in their research papers, 2 used personal/family experience, and 3 used personal interviews. I spoke to every student in the class who utilized the guidelines.

Show Examples:

EXAMPLE #1- Turkish Kurds (two other similar examples Amber and Emma)

How she cited it

Then how she used it for specific example, adding additional evidence, then when making recommendations, able to ask directly what a person wants, grounded in what people on the ground think.

Reflections: found similar stories on kurdishproject.org, but not in scholarly articles. -Scholarly articles are written by westerners focus on general themes like nationalism -Scholarly Articles written by kurds – are afraid to write about it because of laws.

If didn't have it, would have written a different paper about nationalism more broadly without these details.

10 more papers – excited bubbling with ideas – said she was actually really glad for the opportunity to talk to me about her paper writing experience during the interview

EXAMPLE #2 – US Immigration Detention Centers – used her personal and family experience – as a mexican-american family, and a research trip she went on to the U.S. southern border to investigate human rights issues and immigration. She used it to:

- 1) discuss how people are often uninformed about the realities on the ground, and how lack of knowledge allows for the atrocities to continue – based on her experience and conversations in the border region.
- 2) How racist ideas of immigrants, particularly from mexico, and criminality create an environment that allow atrocities to continue based on her own personal family experience and interactions with her peers.

Reflections:

- Was looking at the ICE website, felt very strongly about it, if she can use this as a source, why not from the perspective of the people who are suffering
- Was able to use her own voice, felt personally invested in the paper. If she couldn't have used the personal experience, could have chosen any paper topic and it wouldn't have mattered as much. Not just repeating back other people's ideas.

BASED ON CONVERSATIONS WITH STUDENTS:

Positive Impact (whether or not they used the guidelines)

- Considering own position in relation to research
- Everyone was thinking about credibility of sources, how to corroborate information, and the biases in certain sources.
- Enabled students to ground their analysis and consider the policy impact on every-day lives, see how policy and theory plays out in reality, in people's lives. Helps ground their work.

Challenges to address going forward

- Goes against training from Middle School to University – if this is not a larger, bigger institutional change, how useful is it really – not accepted widely, and it is intimidating because we don't know how to do it and we've been taught to NOT do it.
- How to incorporate into writing – better examples, and more coaching during whole class, how to incorporate into writing, ideas of when it is ok and when not. Connect to course readings that have examples, more examples
- Goes against training from middle school through University – how you are taught to write
- Struggle to see value in own viewpoint – how even as an outsider say, on a study abroad trip, you may not be able to speak from the perspective of the people you meet, but you can speak to your own perspective and that has value too. See value in the stories and experiences of their everyday lives, even in middle class U.S., about gender & race, for example. Students are also concerned about "Don't want to make it all about me." We can improve by Guiding students how to reflect and understand their own place in the world, and the value they bring.
- What are the Boundaries? How do you know how far you can take it – when is it your own opinion versus "fact" of what happened? "How much to push and where to stop?" "confused own personal interpretation versus event that occurred"

THANK YOU!

WOULD LIKE TO BE IN CONTACT

I would like to hear your reactions, ideas to improve...who else is doing this kind of work, who should I talk to.

This page titled [3.6: 2019 Praxis Presentation](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Emily Willard](#), [Emma Macdonald-Scott](#), and [Jake Lally](#).

Index IndexEdit Update titlecancel

D
dire

Detailed Licensing Detailed LicensingEdit Update titlecancel

Overview

Title: [Our Voices: A Guide to Citing Personal Experience and Interviews in Research \(Willard, Macdonald-Scott, and Lally\)](#)

Webpages: 32

Applicable Restrictions: Noncommercial

All licenses found:

- [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#): 93.8% (30 pages)
- [Undeclared](#): 6.3% (2 pages)

By Page

- [Our Voices: A Guide to Citing Personal Experience and Interviews in Research \(Willard, Macdonald-Scott, and Lally\)](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [Front Matter](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [TitlePage](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [InfoPage](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [Table of Contents](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Licensing](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1: The Guidelines](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.1: Introduction](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.2: Framing](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.3: Collaborative Design](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.4: Bringing Theory into Practice](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.5: Discussion and Reflections](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.6: Conclusion](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.7: The Guidelines](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.8: Bibliography](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2: Classroom Tools](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2.1: Sample Syllabus](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2.2: Consent Form](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2.3: Course Design](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2.4: Interview Best Practices](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3: Open Data](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.1: Course Evaluation Notes](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.2: Notes from Interviews with Students \(2018\)](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.3: Notes from Interviews with Students \(2019\)](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.4: Notes from Interview with Graduate Student \(2020\)](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.5: Notes from Interviews with Professors and Instructors](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.6: 2019 Praxis Presentation](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [Back Matter](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [Index](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [Glossary](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [Detailed Licensing](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [Detailed Licensing](#) - [Undeclared](#)

Detailed Licensing Detailed LicensingEdit Update titlecancel

Overview

Title: [Our Voices: A Guide to Citing Personal Experience and Interviews in Research \(Willard, Macdonald-Scott, and Lally\)](#)

Webpages: 32

Applicable Restrictions: Noncommercial

All licenses found:

- [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#): 93.8% (30 pages)
- [Undeclared](#): 6.3% (2 pages)

By Page

- [Our Voices: A Guide to Citing Personal Experience and Interviews in Research \(Willard, Macdonald-Scott, and Lally\)](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [Front Matter](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [TitlePage](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [InfoPage](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [Table of Contents](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Licensing](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1: The Guidelines](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.1: Introduction](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.2: Framing](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.3: Collaborative Design](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.4: Bringing Theory into Practice](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.5: Discussion and Reflections](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.6: Conclusion](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.7: The Guidelines](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.8: Bibliography](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2: Classroom Tools](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2.1: Sample Syllabus](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2.2: Consent Form](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2.3: Course Design](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2.4: Interview Best Practices](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3: Open Data](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.1: Course Evaluation Notes](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.2: Notes from Interviews with Students \(2018\)](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.3: Notes from Interviews with Students \(2019\)](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.4: Notes from Interview with Graduate Student \(2020\)](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.5: Notes from Interviews with Professors and Instructors](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.6: 2019 Praxis Presentation](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [Back Matter](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [Index](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [Glossary](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [Detailed Licensing](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [Detailed Licensing](#) - [Undeclared](#)